EN4554 Deep Learning for Vision — Assignment 2: CNNs on CIFAR-10

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GitHub: https://github.com/achintha-hathurusingha/en4554-a02-cnns

Use of AI tools. I used Claude to help write and debug code and to draft explanations. I ran every experiment myself and I have reviewed and understood all code and text.

0 · Setup

How this works

- One config cell holds every switch. `RUN_TRAINING = False` rebuilds all plots and tables from the saved JSON histories, so a Colab disconnect never forces retraining.
- Results go to Google Drive on Colab and to `./results` elsewhere. The code is device-agnostic: it uses CUDA when available, otherwise the CPU.
- `seed_everything` seeds Python, NumPy and PyTorch (CPU and every GPU), and returns a seeded generator used for mini-batch shuffling.

```
import os, sys, io, copy, json, math, time, random, platform, warnings, contextlib, subprocess
from pathlib import Path

import numpy as np
import torch
import torch.nn as nn
import torch.nn.functional as F
import torchvision
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
%config InlineBackend.figure_format = "retina"

RUN_TRAINING = True    # False: never train; rebuild every plot/table from saved JSON histories
FORCE_RETRAIN = False  # True: retrain even when a saved history exists
SEED = 0

IN_COLAB = "google.colab" in sys.modules
if IN_COLAB:
    from google.colab import drive
    drive.mount("/content/drive")
    ROOT = Path("/content/drive/MyDrive/en4554_a2")
    DATA_DIR = Path("/content/data")                # Colab's local disk is faster than Drive
else:
    ROOT = Path(os.environ.get("A2_ROOT", ".")).resolve()
    DATA_DIR = ROOT / "data"
RESULTS_DIR = ROOT / "results"
CKPT_DIR = RESULTS_DIR / "ckpt"
CKPT_DIR.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)

DEVICE = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")
AMP = DEVICE.type == "cuda"                         # mixed precision only on a GPU
DEVICE_NAME = torch.cuda.get_device_name(0) if AMP else (platform.processor() or "CPU")
```

```
warnings.filterwarnings("ignore", message=r"Detected call of `lr_scheduler\.step\(\)`")

print(f"Python {platform.python_version()} | torch {torch.__version__} | "
      f"torchvision {torchvision.__version__}")
print(f"device: {DEVICE_NAME} | AMP: {AMP} | results -> {RESULTS_DIR}")
```

```
Python 3.12.3 | torch 2.5.1+cu124 | torchvision 0.20.1+cu124
device: Quadro RTX 5000 | AMP: True | results -> /mnt/minura/minura/en4554-a2/results
```

```
def seed_everything(seed=SEED):
    """Seed Python, NumPy and PyTorch (CPU + all GPUs); return a generator for shuffling."""
    random.seed(seed)
    np.random.seed(seed)
    torch.manual_seed(seed)
    torch.cuda.manual_seed_all(seed)
    return torch.Generator().manual_seed(seed)

torch.backends.cudnn.benchmark = True   # fastest conv algorithms; reruns may differ in last digits
seed_everything()

# one colour per method, reused in every figure (Okabe-Ito palette, colour-blind safe)
COLORS = {"train": "#0072B2", "val": "#E69F00",
          "SGD": "#0072B2", "SGD+momentum": "#E69F00", "Adam": "#009E73",
          "sigmoid": "#CC79A7", "ReLU": "#56B4E9",
          "plain": "#999999", "residual": "#0072B2"}
plt.rcParams.update({
    "figure.dpi": 110, "font.size": 10, "axes.titlesize": 10, "axes.labelsize": 10,
    "xtick.labelsize": 8.5, "ytick.labelsize": 8.5, "legend.fontsize": 8.5, "legend.frameon": False,
    "axes.spines.top": False, "axes.spines.right": False, "axes.titlelocation": "left",
    "axes.grid": True, "grid.alpha": 0.25, "grid.linewidth": 0.6,
})
```

1 · Data: seeded 45k / 5k split and training-split normalisation

How this works

- A seeded `randperm` of the 50,000 training images gives the 45k training and 5k validation indices. The same seed always gives the same split, on any machine.
- Per-channel mean and std are computed on the **45k training split only**, so the validation split never leaks into preprocessing: $\hat{x}_c = (x_c/255 - \mu_c)/\sigma_c$.
- The normalised tensors live on the GPU (45k × 3 × 32 × 32 float32 = 553 MB). `batches()` slices them with a seeded permutation. This shuffles the same way as `DataLoader(shuffle=True, generator=g)` but avoids a CPU data-loading bottleneck.
- The test set is not loaded here. It is used once, in Task 4.

```
train_set = torchvision.datasets.CIFAR10(DATA_DIR, train=True, download=True)
CLASSES = train_set.classes
X_all = torch.from_numpy(train_set.data).permute(0, 3, 1, 2).contiguous()  # uint8 (50000,3,32,32)
y_all = torch.tensor(train_set.targets)

perm = torch.randperm(len(X_all), generator=torch.Generator().manual_seed(SEED))
tr_idx, va_idx = perm[:45_000], perm[45_000:]
X_tr_u8, y_tr = X_all[tr_idx], y_all[tr_idx]
X_va_u8, y_va = X_all[va_idx], y_all[va_idx]
```

```
x01 = X_tr_u8.float().div_(255)                       # training split only, scaled to [0, 1]
MEAN, STD = x01.mean(dim=(0, 2, 3)), x01.std(dim=(0, 2, 3))
del x01

print(f"train {tuple(X_tr_u8.shape)} | val {tuple(X_va_u8.shape)} | shared indices: "
      f"{len(set(tr_idx.tolist()) & set(va_idx.tolist()))}")
print("channel mean (R, G, B):", MEAN.numpy().round(4), "| channel std:", STD.numpy().round(4))
```

```
Files already downloaded and verified
train (45000, 3, 32, 32) | val (5000, 3, 32, 32) | shared indices: 0
channel mean (R, G, B): [0.4912 0.482  0.4464] | channel std: [0.2472 0.2436 0.2617]
```

```
def normalize(x_u8):
    """uint8 images -> float32 with zero mean / unit std per channel (training-split statistics)."""
    return (x_u8.float().div(255) - MEAN.view(1, 3, 1, 1)) / STD.view(1, 3, 1, 1)

X_tr, X_va = normalize(X_tr_u8).to(DEVICE), normalize(X_va_u8).to(DEVICE)
y_tr, y_va = y_tr.to(DEVICE), y_va.to(DEVICE)

def batches(X, y, batch_size, shuffle=False, gen=None):
    """Yield (x, y) mini-batches; shuffling uses the seeded CPU generator `gen`."""
    order = torch.randperm(len(X), generator=gen) if shuffle else torch.arange(len(X))
    order = order.to(X.device)
    for i in range(0, len(X), batch_size):
        idx = order[i:i + batch_size]
        yield X[idx], y[idx]

print(f"on {DEVICE}: X_tr {tuple(X_tr.shape)}, X_va {tuple(X_va.shape)}")
print("normalised train split, per-channel mean:", X_tr.mean((0, 2, 3)).cpu().numpy().round(3),
      "| std:", X_tr.std((0, 2, 3)).cpu().numpy().round(3))
print("normalised val split,   per-channel mean:", X_va.mean((0, 2, 3)).cpu().numpy().round(3),
      "| std:", X_va.std((0, 2, 3)).cpu().numpy().round(3))
```

```
on cuda: X_tr (45000, 3, 32, 32), X_va (5000, 3, 32, 32)
normalised train split, per-channel mean: [0. 0. 0.] | std: [1. 1. 1.]
normalised val split,   per-channel mean: [0.008 0.007 0.004] | std: [0.995 0.994 0.997]
```

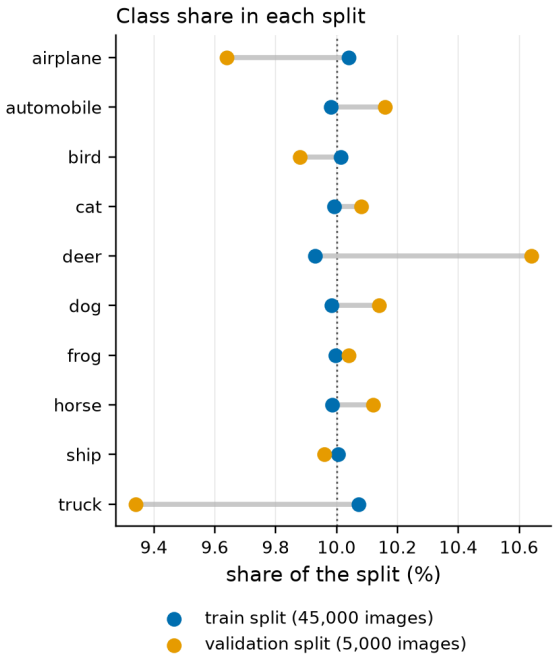
```
fig, (ax_img, ax_bal) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(11, 4.4),
                                     gridspec_kw={"width_ratios": [1.45, 1], "wspace": 0.32})

# left: a strip of 12 training-split images per class
y_cpu, n_show = y_tr.cpu(), 12
rows = []
for c in range(10):
    idx = (y_cpu == c).nonzero().flatten()[:n_show]
    rows.append(torch.cat([F.pad(X_tr_u8[i], (1, 1, 1, 1), value=255) for i in idx], dim=2))
ax_img.imshow(torch.cat(rows, dim=1).permute(1, 2, 0).numpy())
ax_img.set_yticks([34 * c + 17 for c in range(10)], CLASSES)
ax_img.set_xticks([]); ax_img.grid(False); ax_img.tick_params(length=0)
for s in ax_img.spines.values():
    s.set_visible(False)
ax_img.set_title(f"{n_show} training-split images per class")

# right: share of each class in the two splits (perfect balance = the dotted 10 % line)
share = lambda y: (torch.bincount(y.cpu(), minlength=10) / len(y) * 100).numpy()
s_tr, s_va, ypos = share(y_tr), share(y_va), np.arange(10)
ax_bal.hlines(ypos, np.minimum(s_tr, s_va), np.maximum(s_tr, s_va), color="0.8", lw=2.5, zorder=1)
ax_bal.scatter(s_tr, ypos, color=COLORS["train"], s=40, zorder=3,
               label=f"train split ({len(y_tr):,} images)")
ax_bal.scatter(s_va, ypos, color=COLORS["val"], s=40, zorder=3,
               label=f"validation split ({len(y_va):,} images)")
ax_bal.axvline(10, color="0.35", ls=":", lw=1, zorder=0)
ax_bal.set_yticks(ypos, CLASSES); ax_bal.invert_yaxis(); ax_bal.grid(axis="y", visible=False)
ax_bal.set_xlabel("share of the split (%)")
ax_bal.set_title("Class share in each split")
ax_bal.legend(loc="upper center", bbox_to_anchor=(0.45, -0.14), ncol=1)
plt.show()
```

```
print("class counts  train:", torch.bincount(y_tr.cpu(), minlength=10).tolist())
print("              val:  ", torch.bincount(y_va.cpu(), minlength=10).tolist())
```






```
class counts  train: [4518, 4492, 4506, 4496, 4468, 4493, 4498, 4494, 4502, 4533]
              val:   [482, 508, 494, 504, 532, 507, 502, 506, 498, 467]
```

Interpretation. The split is random, not stratified, yet every class stays close to 10 %. Training counts run from 4,468 (deer) to 4,533 (truck), and validation counts from 467 (truck, 9.34 %) to 532 (deer, 10.64 %). The validation split scatters more only because it is nine times smaller: a binomial count of 5,000 × 0.1 has std ≈ 21 images, so the largest deviation (33) is ordinary sampling noise, too small to bias later validation accuracies. After normalising with training statistics (R/G/B mean 0.491/0.482/0.446, std 0.247/0.244/0.262), the training split has mean 0 and std 1 by construction. The validation split sits at means ≤ 0.008 and stds 0.994–0.997, the small offset expected when validation data never enter preprocessing.

Shared training loop (used by Tasks 2–4)

How this works

- `train_one_epoch` runs the forward pass under `torch.autocast` (float16 convolutions and matrix multiplies on the GPU's tensor cores; reductions such as the loss stay in float32).
- `GradScaler` backpropagates $S \cdot L$ instead of L so that small float16 gradients don't underflow to zero. It divides the gradients by S before the update, and skips the step and halves S if any gradient is inf/NaN.
- `evaluate` uses `model.eval()`: batch norm uses its running statistics and dropout is off.

- `run_experiment` trains one configuration and saves its history (losses, accuracies, seconds per epoch) to `results/<name>.json` straight after the run. If the file already exists, it loads it instead of retraining. A loss that becomes inf/NaN stops the run and marks it `diverged`.

```
def n_params(model):
    return sum(p.numel() for p in model.parameters() if p.requires_grad)

@torch.no_grad()
def evaluate(model, X, y, batch_size=1000):
    """Mean cross-entropy and accuracy on (X, y) in eval mode."""
    model.eval()
    loss_sum = torch.zeros((), device=X.device)
    correct = torch.zeros((), device=X.device)
    for xb, yb in batches(X, y, batch_size):
        with torch.autocast(DEVICE.type, dtype=torch.float16, enabled=AMP):
            logits = model(xb)
        loss_sum += F.cross_entropy(logits.float(), yb, reduction="sum")
        correct += (logits.argmax(1) == yb).sum()
    return loss_sum.item() / len(X), correct.item() / len(X)

def train_one_epoch(model, opt, scaler, X, y, gen, batch_size=128, sched=None,
                    augment=None, mix_fn=None, label_smoothing=0.0):
    """One pass over (X, y); returns the mean training loss on the (augmented) batches."""
    model.train()
    loss_sum, n = torch.zeros((), device=X.device), 0
    for xb, yb in batches(X, y, batch_size, shuffle=True, gen=gen):
        if augment is not None:
            xb = augment(xb)
        with torch.autocast(DEVICE.type, dtype=torch.float16, enabled=AMP):
            if mix_fn is None:
                loss = F.cross_entropy(model(xb), yb, label_smoothing=label_smoothing)
            else:                           # mixup: the loss mixes the two labels like the images
                xb, ya, yb2, lam = mix_fn(xb, yb)
                logits = model(xb)
                loss = lam * F.cross_entropy(logits, ya) + (1 - lam) * F.cross_entropy(logits, yb2)
        opt.zero_grad(set_to_none=True)
        scaler.scale(loss).backward()       # backprop S*L so fp16 gradients don't underflow
        scaler.step(opt)                    # unscale, then step (skipped if a grad is inf/NaN)
        scaler.update()
        if sched is not None:
            sched.step()                                # schedules here step once per mini-batch
        loss_sum += loss.detach() * len(xb)
        n += len(xb)
    return loss_sum.item() / n
```

```
def run_experiment(name, make_model, make_opt, epochs, X=None, y=None, batch_size=128,
                   make_sched=None, augment=None, mix_fn=None, label_smoothing=0.0,
                   eval_train=None, seed=SEED, save_model=False, log_every=None):
    """Train one configuration (or load its saved history) and return the per-epoch history dict."""
    path = RESULTS_DIR / f"{name}.json"
    if path.exists() and not FORCE_RETRAIN:
        h = json.loads(path.read_text())
        print(f"[loaded] {name}: val acc {h['val_acc'][-1]:.2%} after {len(h['val_acc'])} epochs, "
              f"{np.mean(h['epoch_time']):.1f} s/epoch on {h['device']}")
        return h
    if not RUN_TRAINING:
        raise FileNotFoundError(f"{path} is missing and RUN_TRAINING is False")
    X = X_tr if X is None else X
    y = y_tr if y is None else y
    gen = seed_everything(seed)                     # same seed -> same init, same batch order
    model = make_model().to(DEVICE)
    opt = make_opt(model.parameters())
```

```
    sched = make_sched(opt, epochs * math.ceil(len(X) / batch_size)) if make_sched else None
    scaler = torch.amp.GradScaler(DEVICE.type, enabled=AMP)
    h = {"name": name, "params": n_params(model), "device": DEVICE_NAME, "seed": seed,
         "diverged": False,
         "train_loss": [], "val_loss": [], "val_acc": [], "train_acc": [], "epoch_time": []}
    log_every = log_every or max(1, epochs // 5)
    for ep in range(1, epochs + 1):
        t0 = time.perf_counter()
        tl = train_one_epoch(model, opt, scaler, X, y, gen, batch_size, sched,
                             augment, mix_fn, label_smoothing)
        if AMP:
            torch.cuda.synchronize()
        h["epoch_time"].append(time.perf_counter() - t0)
        vl, va = evaluate(model, X_va, y_va)
        h["train_loss"].append(tl); h["val_loss"].append(vl); h["val_acc"].append(va)
        if eval_train is not None:                    # e.g. clean (un-augmented) training images
            h["train_acc"].append(evaluate(model, *eval_train)[1])
        diverged = not math.isfinite(tl)
        if ep == 1 or ep % log_every == 0 or diverged:
            print(f"{name} | epoch {ep:>3}/{epochs} | train loss {tl:.4f} | val loss {vl:.4f} | "
                  f"val acc {va:.2%} | {h['epoch_time'][-1]:.1f} s/epoch")
        if diverged:
            h["diverged"] = True
            print(f"{name}: training loss is not finite -> run stopped (diverged)")
            break
    path.write_text(json.dumps(h))
    if save_model:
        torch.save(model.state_dict(), CKPT_DIR / f"{name}.pt")
    return h

def load_history(name):
    return json.loads((RESULTS_DIR / f"{name}.json").read_text())
```

Task 1 · Backpropagation by hand (L04, L06)

(a) Linear, ReLU, sigmoid and softmax cross-entropy with explicit forward/backward

How this works

- Each layer caches what its backward pass needs. `backward(g)` receives $g = \partial L/\partial(\text{output})$ and returns $\partial L/\partial(\text{input})$, which is the chain rule applied one layer at a time. No autograd is used.
- Linear, $y = xW + b$ (the linear score function of L04) with $x \in \mathbb{R}^{N\times D}$, $W \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times M}$:
  $$\frac{\partial L}{\partial W} = x^\top g, \qquad \frac{\partial L}{\partial b} = \sum_n g_n, \qquad \frac{\partial L}{\partial x} = g\,W^\top$$
- ReLU: $\partial L/\partial x = g \odot \mathbb{1}[x > 0]$ (the mask). Sigmoid: $\partial L/\partial x = g \odot \sigma(x)(1-\sigma(x))$.
- Softmax cross-entropy (the L04 classifier loss): $p = \text{softmax}(z)$, $L = -\frac{1}{N}\sum_n \log p_{n,y_n}$, so $\dfrac{\partial L}{\partial z} = \dfrac{p - Y}{N}$ with Y one-hot. Subtracting $\max_j z_j$ first leaves p unchanged and prevents `exp` overflow.

```
class Linear:
    """y = x @ W + b, W of shape (d_in, d_out). Caches x for the backward pass."""
    def __init__(self, d_in, d_out, init="kaiming", dtype=torch.float32, device=DEVICE):
        std = math.sqrt(2 / d_in) if init == "kaiming" else math.sqrt(2 / (d_in + d_out))
```

```
        self.W = (torch.randn(d_in, d_out, dtype=torch.float64) * std).to(device, dtype)
        self.b = torch.zeros(d_out, dtype=dtype, device=device)

    def forward(self, x):
        self.x = x
        return x @ self.W + self.b

    def backward(self, g):              # g = dL/dy, shape (N, d_out)
        self.dW = self.x.T @ g          # dL/dW = x^T g
        self.db = g.sum(0)              # dL/db = sum of g over the batch
        return g @ self.W.T             # dL/dx = g W^T


class ReLU:
    def forward(self, x):
        self.mask = x > 0
        return x * self.mask

    def backward(self, g):
        return g * self.mask            # derivative is 1 where x > 0, else 0


class Sigmoid:
    def forward(self, x):
        self.s = 1 / (1 + torch.exp(-x))
        return self.s

    def backward(self, g):
        return g * self.s * (1 - self.s)   # sigma' = sigma (1 - sigma) <= 0.25


class SoftmaxCrossEntropy:
    def forward(self, z, y):
        z = z - z.max(dim=1, keepdim=True).values             # stability shift, p unchanged
        logp = z - z.exp().sum(dim=1, keepdim=True).log()     # log-softmax
        self.p, self.y = logp.exp(), y
        return -logp[torch.arange(len(y), device=y.device), y].mean()

    def backward(self):
        g = self.p.clone()
        g[torch.arange(len(self.y), device=g.device), self.y] -= 1   # p - one_hot(y)
        return g / len(self.y)                                       # mean over batch -> / N
```

```
class MLP:
    """Linear -> act -> ... -> Linear, with a manual backward pass and a plain SGD step."""
    def __init__(self, sizes, act=ReLU, init="kaiming", dtype=torch.float32, device=DEVICE):
        self.layers = []
        for i, (d_in, d_out) in enumerate(zip(sizes[:-1], sizes[1:])):
            self.layers.append(Linear(d_in, d_out, init, dtype, device))
            if i < len(sizes) - 2:
                self.layers.append(act())
        self.linears = [layer for layer in self.layers if isinstance(layer, Linear)]
        self.criterion = SoftmaxCrossEntropy()

    def forward(self, x):
        for layer in self.layers:
            x = layer.forward(x)
        return x

    def loss(self, x, y):
        return self.criterion.forward(self.forward(x), y)

    def backward(self):                 # chain rule from the loss back to the input
        g = self.criterion.backward()
        for layer in reversed(self.layers):
            g = layer.backward(g)
```

```
    def sgd_step(self, lr):
        for lin in self.linears:
            lin.W -= lr * lin.dW
            lin.b -= lr * lin.db

    def n_params(self):
        return sum(lin.W.numel() + lin.b.numel() for lin in self.linears)

print("MLP 3072-512-256-10 parameters:", f"{MLP([3072, 512, 256, 10]).n_params():,}")
```

```
MLP 3072-512-256-10 parameters: 1,707,274
```

(b) Gradient check in float64: against autograd and centred finite differences

How this works

- The check runs in float64, so rounding (about 10^{-16}) can't hide a wrong formula. It uses an MLP 3072-64-32-10 (ReLU) on 16 real training images.
- Reference 1 is **autograd** on an independent copy of the forward pass built from `torch.relu` and `F.cross_entropy`. It checks every gradient entry.
- Reference 2 is **centred differences**, $\frac{L(\theta_k + h) - L(\theta_k - h)}{2h}$ with error $O(h^2)$ and $h = 10^{-6}$, on 20 random entries per tensor.
- Relative error: $\frac{|a - b|}{\max(|a|, |b|, 10^{-12})}$. The table reports the largest value per tensor, and `torch.allclose` uses its defaults, `rtol=1e-5` and `atol=1e-8`.

```
seed_everything()
net = MLP([3072, 64, 32, 10], dtype=torch.float64)
xb, yb = X_tr[:16].flatten(1).double(), y_tr[:16]
loss = net.loss(xb, yb)
net.backward()
tensors, manual = {}, {}
for i, lin in enumerate(net.linears, 1):
    tensors[f"W{i}"], tensors[f"b{i}"] = lin.W, lin.b
    manual[f"W{i}"], manual[f"b{i}"] = lin.dW, lin.db

# reference 1: autograd on an independent functional copy of the network
ref = [t.clone().requires_grad_() for t in tensors.values()]
h = xb
for i in range(0, len(ref), 2):
    h = h @ ref[i] + ref[i + 1]
    if i < len(ref) - 2:
        h = torch.relu(h)
loss_ag = F.cross_entropy(h, yb)
loss_ag.backward()
autograd = {name: t.grad for name, t in zip(tensors, ref)}

def rel_err(a, b):
    return (a - b).abs() / torch.clamp(torch.maximum(a.abs(), b.abs()), min=1e-12)

# reference 2: centred finite differences on K random entries per tensor
H, K = 1e-6, 20
gen = torch.Generator().manual_seed(SEED)
rows = []
for name, theta in tensors.items():
```

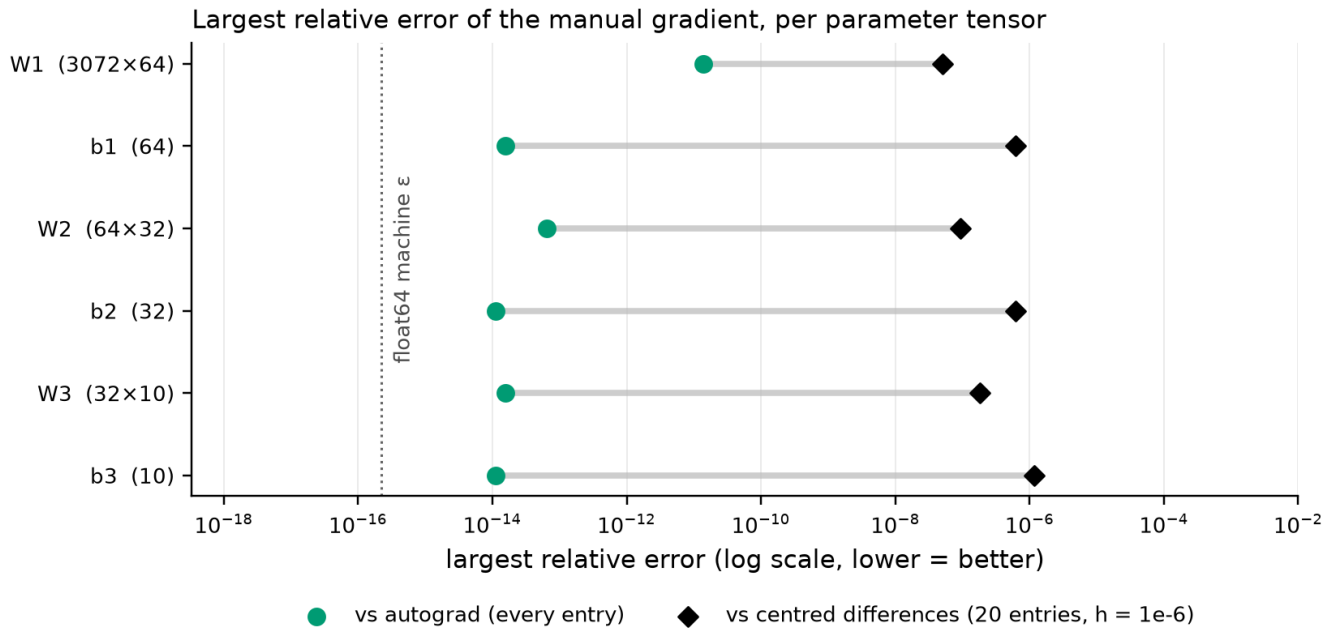
```
    flat = theta.view(-1)                                  # a view: editing it edits the weights
    idx = torch.randperm(flat.numel(), generator=gen)[:K]
    fd = torch.empty(len(idx), dtype=torch.float64)
    for j, k in enumerate(idx.tolist()):
        old = flat[k].item()
        flat[k] = old + H; l_plus = net.loss(xb, yb).item()
        flat[k] = old - H; l_minus = net.loss(xb, yb).item()
        flat[k] = old
        fd[j] = (l_plus - l_minus) / (2 * H)
    g_man = manual[name].reshape(-1)[idx].cpu()
    rows.append({"tensor": name, "shape": "×".join(map(str, theta.shape)),
                 "max rel. error vs autograd": rel_err(manual[name], autograd[name]).max().item(),
                 "allclose vs autograd": torch.allclose(manual[name], autograd[name]),
                 "entries checked by FD": len(idx),
                 "max rel. error vs FD": rel_err(g_man, fd).max().item(),
                 "allclose vs FD": torch.allclose(g_man, fd)})
```

```
gc = pd.DataFrame(rows)
display(gc.style.format({"max rel. error vs autograd": "{:.1e}", "max rel. error vs FD": "{:.1e}"})
          .hide(axis="index"))
print(f"loss: manual {loss.item():.15f} | F.cross_entropy {loss_ag.item():.15f}")
print("torch.allclose(manual, autograd) for every tensor:", bool(gc["allclose vs autograd"].all()))
print("torch.allclose(manual, finite differences) for every tensor:",
      bool(gc["allclose vs FD"].all()))

# figure: largest relative error per tensor on a log axis (exact zeros drawn at the floor)
floor = 1e-18
fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(8, 3.3))
ypos = np.arange(len(gc))
ag = np.maximum(gc["max rel. error vs autograd"].to_numpy(), floor)
fdv = np.maximum(gc["max rel. error vs FD"].to_numpy(), floor)
ax.hlines(ypos, np.minimum(ag, fdv), np.maximum(ag, fdv), color="0.82", lw=2.5, zorder=1)
ax.scatter(ag, ypos, color="#009E73", s=42, zorder=3, label="vs autograd (every entry)")
ax.scatter(fdv, ypos, color="black", marker="D", s=30, zorder=3,
           label=f"vs centred differences ({K} entries, h = 1e-6)")
eps64 = np.finfo(np.float64).eps
ax.axvline(eps64, color="0.4", ls=":", lw=1)
ax.text(eps64 * 1.5, (len(gc) - 1) / 2, "float64 machine ε", rotation=90, va="center",
        fontsize=8.5, color="0.3")
ax.set_xscale("log"); ax.set_xlim(floor / 3, 1e-2)
ax.set_yticks(ypos, [f"{t}  ({s})" for t, s in zip(gc["tensor"], gc["shape"])]); ax.invert_yaxis()
ax.grid(axis="y", visible=False)
ax.set_xlabel("largest relative error (log scale, lower = better)")
ax.set_title("Largest relative error of the manual gradient, per parameter tensor")
ax.legend(loc="upper center", bbox_to_anchor=(0.5, -0.2), ncol=2)
plt.show()
```

tensor	shape	max rel. error vs autograd	allclose vs autograd	entries checked by FD	max rel. error vs FD	allclose vs FD
W1	3072×64	1.4e-11	True	20	5.1e-08	True
b1	64	1.6e-14	True	20	6.1e-07	True
W2	64×32	6.5e-14	True	20	9.2e-08	True
b2	32	1.1e-14	True	20	6.2e-07	True
W3	32×10	1.6e-14	True	20	1.8e-07	True
b3	10	1.1e-14	True	10	1.2e-06	True

```
loss: manual 3.061597340901310 | F.cross_entropy 3.061597340901310
torch.allclose(manual, autograd) for every tensor: True
torch.allclose(manual, finite differences) for every tensor: True
```



Interpretation. All six tensors pass both checks: `torch.allclose` is True against autograd and against centred differences, and the two losses agree to 15 decimals (3.061597340901310). Against autograd the largest relative errors are 1.1×10^{-14}–1.4×10^{-11}, rounding-level differences from a different order of floating-point operations. That confirms $x^\top g$, $\sum g$, $gW^\top$, the ReLU mask and $(p - Y)/N$. The finite-difference errors are larger (5.1×10^{-8}–1.2×10^{-6}) because of the reference itself: subtracting two losses of ≈ 3.06 loses about $\varepsilon L/h \approx 7 \times 10^{-10}$, on top of the $O(h^2)$ truncation, which is large relative to the smallest gradient entries. A real bug, such as a missing $1/N$, would give relative errors near 1.

(c) Training the hand-written MLP with plain SGD

How this works

- MLP 3072-512-256-10 with ReLU and Kaiming init, trained on flattened, normalised images with plain mini-batch SGD, $\theta \leftarrow \theta - \eta\, \partial L/\partial\theta$. Settings: $\eta = 0.05$ constant, batch 128, 20 epochs.
- Gradients come only from the manual `backward()`. The loop runs under `torch.no_grad()`, so autograd never records anything.
- Training accuracy is measured on a fixed, clean 5k subset of the training split at the end of each epoch. The history is saved to `results/task1c_mlp.json`.

```
def train_manual_mlp(sizes=(3072, 512, 256, 10), lr=0.05, epochs=20, batch_size=128, seed=SEED):
    gen = seed_everything(seed)
    net = MLP(list(sizes))
    Xf, Xv = X_tr.flatten(1), X_va.flatten(1)
    h = {"name": "task1c_mlp", "params": net.n_params(), "lr": lr, "batch_size": batch_size,
         "device": DEVICE_NAME, "iter_loss": [], "train_loss": [], "val_loss": [], "val_acc": [],
         "train_acc": [], "epoch_time": []}
```

```
    def loss_acc(X, y):
        loss_sum, correct = 0.0, 0
        for xb, yb in batches(X, y, 1000):
            z = net.forward(xb)
            loss_sum += net.criterion.forward(z, yb).item() * len(xb)
            correct += (z.argmax(1) == yb).sum().item()
        return loss_sum / len(X), correct / len(X)

    with torch.no_grad():                                   # no autograd anywhere
        for ep in range(1, epochs + 1):
            t0, losses = time.perf_counter(), []
            for xb, yb in batches(Xf, y_tr, batch_size, shuffle=True, gen=gen):
                losses.append(net.loss(xb, yb))
                net.backward()
                net.sgd_step(lr)
            losses = torch.stack(losses).tolist()
            if AMP:
                torch.cuda.synchronize()
            h["epoch_time"].append(time.perf_counter() - t0)
            vl, va = loss_acc(Xv, y_va)
            _, ta = loss_acc(Xf[:5000], y_tr[:5000])
            h["iter_loss"] += losses
            h["train_loss"].append(float(np.mean(losses)))
            h["val_loss"].append(vl); h["val_acc"].append(va); h["train_acc"].append(ta)
            if ep == 1 or ep % 5 == 0:
                print(f"epoch {ep:>2}/{epochs} | train loss {h['train_loss'][-1]:.4f} | "
                      f"val loss {vl:.4f} | val acc {va:.2%} | {h['epoch_time'][-1]:.2f} s/epoch")
    return h

path_1c = RESULTS_DIR / "task1c_mlp.json"
if path_1c.exists() and not FORCE_RETRAIN:
    h1c = load_history("task1c_mlp"); print("[loaded]", path_1c.name)
elif RUN_TRAINING:
    h1c = train_manual_mlp()
    path_1c.write_text(json.dumps(h1c))
else:
    raise FileNotFoundError(path_1c)
best = int(np.argmax(h1c["val_acc"]))
print(f"final val acc {h1c['val_acc'][-1]:.2%} | best {h1c['val_acc'][best]:.2%} "
      f"(epoch {best + 1}) | final train-subset acc {h1c['train_acc'][-1]:.2%} | "
      f"{np.mean(h1c['epoch_time']):.2f} s/epoch")
```

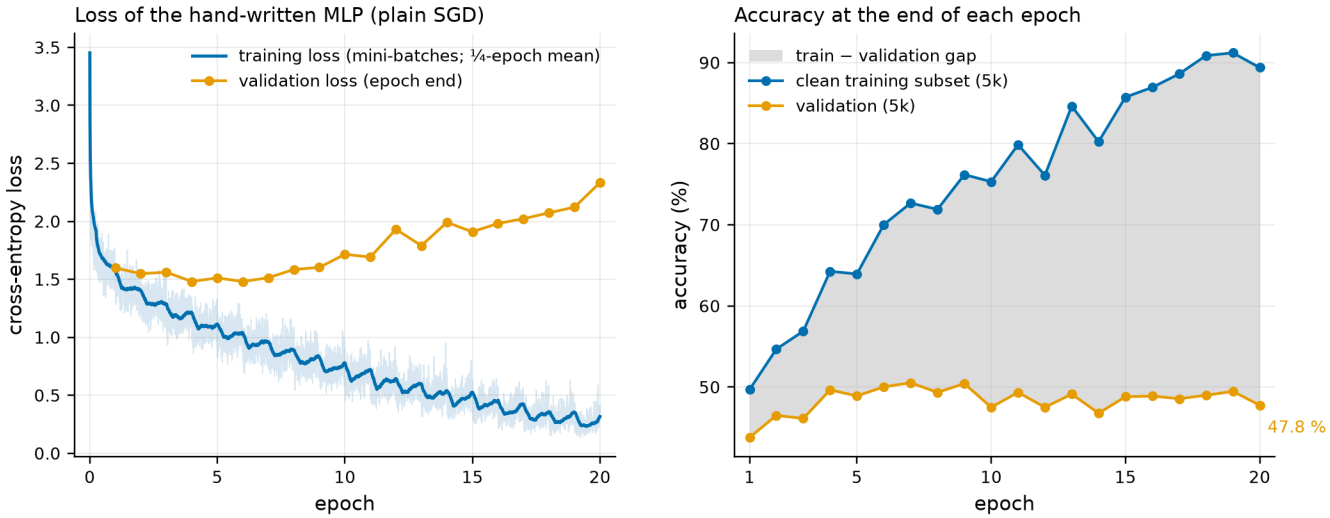
```
epoch  1/20 | train loss 1.6999 | val loss 1.5981 | val acc 43.78% | 0.38 s/epoch
epoch  5/20 | train loss 1.0945 | val loss 1.5120 | val acc 48.90% | 0.37 s/epoch
epoch 10/20 | train loss 0.7361 | val loss 1.7155 | val acc 47.50% | 0.37 s/epoch
epoch 15/20 | train loss 0.4649 | val loss 1.9091 | val acc 48.80% | 0.37 s/epoch
epoch 20/20 | train loss 0.2627 | val loss 2.3339 | val acc 47.76% | 0.37 s/epoch
final val acc 47.76% | best 50.52% (epoch 7) | final train-subset acc 89.38% | 0.37 s/epoch
```

```
spe = len(h1c["iter_loss"]) // len(h1c["train_loss"])           # steps per epoch
it = np.arange(1, len(h1c["iter_loss"]) + 1) / spe
ep = np.arange(1, len(h1c["val_loss"]) + 1)
smooth = pd.Series(h1c["iter_loss"]).rolling(spe // 4, min_periods=1).mean()
tr_acc, va_acc = 100 * np.array(h1c["train_acc"]), 100 * np.array(h1c["val_acc"])

fig, (ax_l, ax_a) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(11, 3.9), gridspec_kw={"wspace": 0.22})
ax_l.plot(it, h1c["iter_loss"], color=COLORS["train"], alpha=0.15, lw=0.6)
ax_l.plot(it, smooth, color=COLORS["train"], lw=1.6,
          label="training loss (mini-batches; ¼-epoch mean)")
ax_l.plot(ep, h1c["val_loss"], "o-", color=COLORS["val"], ms=4, lw=1.4,
          label="validation loss (epoch end)")
ax_l.set(xlabel="epoch", ylabel="cross-entropy loss",
         title="Loss of the hand-written MLP (plain SGD)")
ax_l.legend(loc="upper right")

ax_a.fill_between(ep, va_acc, tr_acc, color="0.88", lw=0, label="train − validation gap")
```

```
ax_a.plot(ep, tr_acc, "o-", color=COLORS["train"], ms=4, lw=1.4, label="clean training subset (5k)")
ax_a.plot(ep, va_acc, "o-", color=COLORS["val"], ms=4, lw=1.4, label="validation (5k)")
ax_a.annotate(f"{va_acc[-1]:.1f} %", (ep[-1], va_acc[-1]), xytext=(4, -14),
              textcoords="offset points", color=COLORS["val"], fontsize=8.5)
ax_a.set(xlabel="epoch", ylabel="accuracy (%)", title="Accuracy at the end of each epoch")
ax_a.legend(loc="upper left")
ax_l.set_xticks([0, 5, 10, 15, 20]); ax_a.set_xticks([1, 5, 10, 15, 20])
for ax in (ax_l, ax_a):
    ax.margins(x=0.03)
plt.show()
```



Interpretation. The hand-written backward pass trains the network: mean training loss falls from 1.70 (epoch 1) to 0.26 (epoch 20). Validation loss bottoms out at 1.48 in epoch 6 and climbs to 2.33. Validation accuracy peaks at 50.52 % in epoch 7 and ends at 47.76 %, while clean training accuracy reaches 89.4 %: a 41.6-point gap, i.e. overfitting (L05). With 1.7 M parameters, no regularisation, and pixels treated as an unordered vector (no weight sharing, no translation invariance), the MLP memorises the 45k images, which is the motivation for CNNs. Early stopping near epoch 7 would keep the best model; Task 3 studies regularisation.

(d) Gradient norm per layer at initialisation: sigmoid vs ReLU in a 10-layer MLP

How this works

- 10 linear layers (3072 → 256 ×9 → 10) with the same init scheme for both activations. Norms come from the manual backward pass on one fixed batch of 256 training images, with 5 random inits per configuration (line = median, band = min–max).
- Backward through layer l: $\delta_{l-1} = (\delta_l \odot f'(a_l))\, W_l^\top$ and $\partial L/\partial W_l = h_{l-1}^\top (\delta_l \odot f'(a_l))$. Each layer multiplies the signal by f' and a weight matrix, so its norm changes geometrically with depth.
- Sigmoid: $\sigma' = \sigma(1-\sigma) \le 0.25$. ReLU: $f' \in \{0, 1\}$.
- Kaiming init, $\mathrm{std} = \sqrt{2/\mathrm{fan_in}}$, is designed for ReLU (the 2 makes up for the half of the units that output zero). Xavier, $\sqrt{2/(\mathrm{fan_in} + \mathrm{fan_out})}$, has half that variance

on these layers and is shown for comparison.

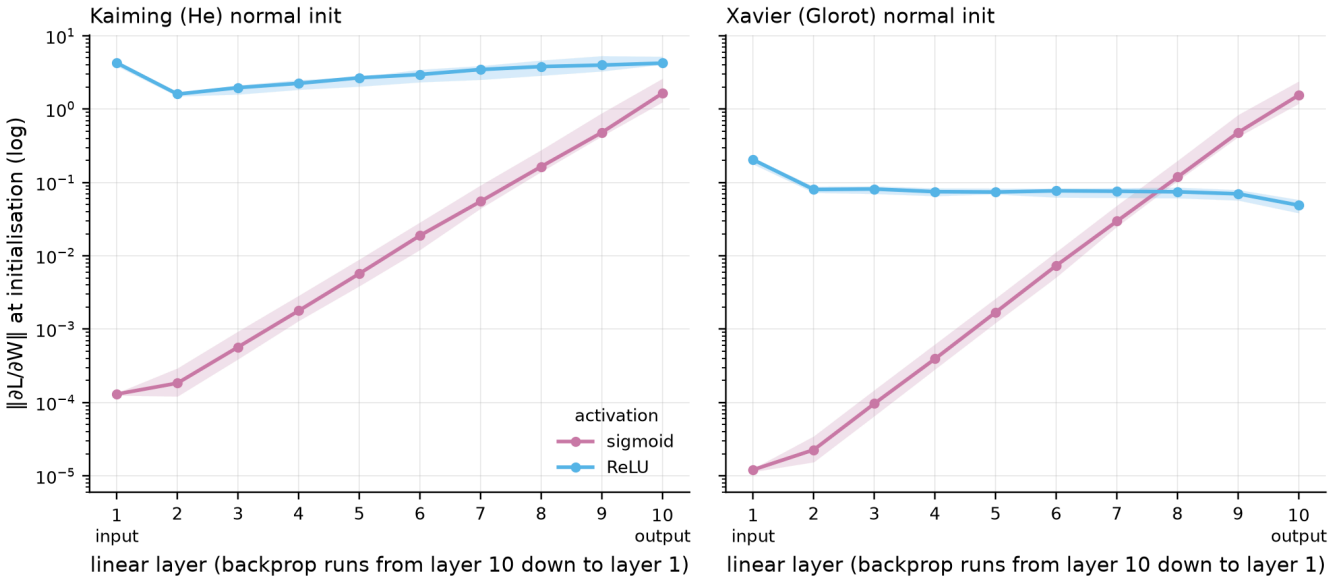
```
def layer_grad_norms(act, init, seed, x, y):
    seed_everything(seed)
    net = MLP([3072] + [256] * 9 + [10], act=act, init=init)
    net.loss(x, y)
    net.backward()
    return [lin.dW.norm().item() for lin in net.linears]      # Frobenius norm of dL/dW_l

xg, yg = X_tr[:256].flatten(1), y_tr[:256]
gn = {(init, act.__name__): np.array([layer_grad_norms(act, init, s, xg, yg) for s in range(5)])
      for init in ("kaiming", "xavier") for act in (Sigmoid, ReLU)}

summary = pd.DataFrame([{"init": init, "activation": act,
                         "‖∂L/∂W₁‖ (input side)": np.median(g[:, 0]),
                         "‖∂L/∂W₁₀‖ (output side)": np.median(g[:, -1]),
                         "layer 1 / layer 10": np.median(g[:, 0]) / np.median(g[:, -1])}
                        for (init, act), g in gn.items()])
display(summary.style.format("{:.2e}", subset=summary.columns[2:]).hide(axis="index"))

layers = np.arange(1, 11)
fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(11, 4.1), sharey=True, gridspec_kw={"wspace": 0.06})
titles = {"kaiming": "Kaiming (He) normal init", "xavier": "Xavier (Glorot) normal init"}
for ax, init in zip(axes, ("kaiming", "xavier")):
    for act, key in (("Sigmoid", "sigmoid"), ("ReLU", "ReLU")):
        g = gn[(init, act)]
        ax.fill_between(layers, g.min(0), g.max(0), color=COLORS[key], alpha=0.22, lw=0)
        ax.plot(layers, np.median(g, 0), "o-", color=COLORS[key], lw=1.8, ms=4, label=key)
    ax.set_yscale("log")
    ax.set_xticks(layers, ["1\ninput"] + [str(i) for i in range(2, 10)] + ["10\noutput"])
    ax.set_xlabel("linear layer (backprop runs from layer 10 down to layer 1)")
    ax.set_title(titles[init])
axes[0].set_ylabel("‖∂L/∂W‖ at initialisation (log)")
axes[0].legend(loc="lower right", title="activation", title_fontsize=8.5)
plt.show()
```

init	activation	‖∂L/∂W₁‖ (input side)	‖∂L/∂W₁₀‖ (output side)	layer 1 / layer 10
kaiming	Sigmoid	1.30e-04	1.65e+00	7.89e-05
kaiming	ReLU	4.27e+00	4.24e+00	1.01e+00
xavier	Sigmoid	1.21e-05	1.55e+00	7.78e-06
xavier	ReLU	2.04e-01	4.89e-02	4.18e+00



Interpretation. With the same Kaiming init, the sigmoid network's gradient norm falls from 1.65 at layer 10 to 1.3×10^{-4} at layer 1 ($\times 7.9 \times 10^{-5}$, about ×0.35 per layer). The ReLU network stays at the same scale (4.24 → 4.27). This is the vanishing-gradient problem: each backward step multiplies δ by $f'(a)$ and by $W^\top$. A Kaiming 256×256 matrix scales the norm by about $\sqrt{2}$ and $\sigma' \le 0.25$, so the sigmoid factor is about $0.25\sqrt{2} \approx 0.35$, as measured; ReLU's derivative is 1 on active units and Kaiming's factor 2 compensates for the inactive half. Initialisation matters too: with Xavier (half the variance), sigmoid decays even faster (7.8×10^{-6}, ×0.27 per layer), and ReLU gradients do not vanish (layer 1 / layer 10 = 4.2) but are 87× smaller at layer 10 (0.049 vs 4.24) because the forward activations shrink by about $\sqrt{2}$ per layer.

Task 2 · Optimizers (L05)

(a) SGD with momentum and Adam as `torch.optim.Optimizer` subclasses

How this works

- **PyTorch momentum:** $v_t = \mu v_{t-1} + g_t$ ($v_1 = g_1$), $\theta_t = \theta_{t-1} - \eta\, v_t$. The lecture form $v \leftarrow \mu v - \eta g,\ \theta \leftarrow \theta + v$ gives the same steps for a constant η; PyTorch's version applies the *current* η to the whole buffer, which matters under a schedule. Weight decay adds $\lambda\theta$ to g.
- **Adam:** $m_t = \beta_1 m_{t-1} + (1-\beta_1) g_t$, $v_t = \beta_2 v_{t-1} + (1-\beta_2) g_t^2$, $\theta_t = \theta_{t-1} - \eta\, \hat{m}_t / (\sqrt{\hat{v}_t} + \epsilon)$ with $\hat{m}_t = m_t/(1-\beta_1^t)$, $\hat{v}_t = v_t/(1-\beta_2^t)$. Bias correction undoes the pull toward the zero initial values: without it the first step would be $\approx 3.2\,\eta\,\mathrm{sign}(g)$, not $\eta\,\mathrm{sign}(g)$.
- **Check:** two identical copies of the small CNN (3 × [conv 3×3 → (BN) → ReLU → max-pool], 32/64/128 channels, FC 2048 → 256 → 10), the same 30 batches, in float64 on

the CPU. Every parameter is compared with `torch.allclose`, and the largest difference is printed.

```
class MySGD(torch.optim.Optimizer):
    """SGD with heavy-ball momentum (PyTorch convention) and L2 weight decay."""
    def __init__(self, params, lr, momentum=0.0, weight_decay=0.0):
        super().__init__(params, dict(lr=lr, momentum=momentum, weight_decay=weight_decay))

    @torch.no_grad()
    def step(self, closure=None):
        loss = None
        if closure is not None:
            with torch.enable_grad():
                loss = closure()
        for group in self.param_groups:
            lr, mu, wd = group["lr"], group["momentum"], group["weight_decay"]
            for p in group["params"]:
                if p.grad is None:
                    continue
                g = p.grad if wd == 0 else p.grad + wd * p        # L2: g <- g + lambda * theta
                if mu != 0:
                    state = self.state[p]
                    if "v" not in state:
                        state["v"] = g.clone()                    # first step: v_1 = g_1
                    else:
                        state["v"].mul_(mu).add_(g)               # v <- mu v + g
                    g = state["v"]
                p.add_(g, alpha=-lr)                              # theta <- theta - lr v
        return loss


class MyAdam(torch.optim.Optimizer):
    """Adam with bias correction (Kingma & Ba, 2015) and L2 weight decay."""
    def __init__(self, params, lr=1e-3, betas=(0.9, 0.999), eps=1e-8, weight_decay=0.0):
        super().__init__(params, dict(lr=lr, betas=betas, eps=eps, weight_decay=weight_decay))

    @torch.no_grad()
    def step(self, closure=None):
        loss = None
        if closure is not None:
            with torch.enable_grad():
                loss = closure()
        for group in self.param_groups:
            lr, (b1, b2), eps, wd = group["lr"], group["betas"], group["eps"], group["weight_decay"]
            for p in group["params"]:
                if p.grad is None:
                    continue
                g = p.grad if wd == 0 else p.grad + wd * p
                state = self.state[p]
                if not state:
                    state["t"], state["m"], state["v"] = 0, torch.zeros_like(p), torch.zeros_like(p)
                state["t"] += 1
                t, m, v = state["t"], state["m"], state["v"]
                m.mul_(b1).add_(g, alpha=1 - b1)                  # first moment (EMA of g)
                v.mul_(b2).addcmul_(g, g, value=1 - b2)           # second moment (EMA of g^2)
                m_hat = m / (1 - b1 ** t)                         # bias correction
                v_hat = v / (1 - b2 ** t)
                p.addcdiv_(m_hat, v_hat.sqrt().add_(eps), value=-lr)
        return loss
```

```
class SmallCNN(nn.Module):
    """3 x [conv3x3 -> (BN) -> ReLU -> maxpool2] (32/64/128 ch), then FC 2048 -> 256 -> 10."""
    def __init__(self, bn=False, p_drop=0.0):
        super().__init__()
```

```
        def block(c_in, c_out):
            layers = [nn.Conv2d(c_in, c_out, 3, padding=1, bias=not bn)]
            if bn:
                layers.append(nn.BatchNorm2d(c_out))
            return layers + [nn.ReLU(inplace=True), nn.MaxPool2d(2)]
        self.features = nn.Sequential(*block(3, 32), *block(32, 64), *block(64, 128))
        self.classifier = nn.Sequential(nn.Flatten(), nn.Linear(128 * 4 * 4, 256),
                                        nn.ReLU(inplace=True), nn.Dropout(p_drop),
                                        nn.Linear(256, 10))

    def forward(self, x):
        return self.classifier(self.features(x))


def compare_with_torch(make_mine, make_ref, n_steps=30, batch=32, seed=SEED):
    torch.manual_seed(seed)
    base = SmallCNN().double()
    m_mine, m_ref = copy.deepcopy(base), copy.deepcopy(base)
    o_mine, o_ref = make_mine(m_mine.parameters()), make_ref(m_ref.parameters())
    Xc = X_tr[:n_steps * batch].cpu().double()
    yc = y_tr[:n_steps * batch].cpu()
    for s in range(n_steps):                                    # identical batches for both copies
        xb, yb = Xc[s * batch:(s + 1) * batch], yc[s * batch:(s + 1) * batch]
        for model, opt in ((m_mine, o_mine), (m_ref, o_ref)):
            opt.zero_grad()
            F.cross_entropy(model(xb), yb).backward()
            opt.step()
    pairs = list(zip(m_mine.parameters(), m_ref.parameters(), base.parameters()))
    return {"allclose (every parameter)": all(torch.allclose(a, b) for a, b, _ in pairs),
            "max |θ_mine − θ_torch|": max((a - b).abs().max().item() for a, b, _ in pairs),
            "max |θ_N − θ_0| (distance moved)":
                max((b - c).abs().max().item() for _, b, c in pairs)}

checks = {
    "SGD, η=0.05":                   (lambda p: MySGD(p, 0.05), lambda p: torch.optim.SGD(p, 0.05)),
    "SGD+momentum, η=0.01, μ=0.9":   (lambda p: MySGD(p, 0.01, momentum=0.9),
                                      lambda p: torch.optim.SGD(p, 0.01, momentum=0.9)),
    "SGD+momentum, + weight decay":  (
        lambda p: MySGD(p, 0.01, momentum=0.9, weight_decay=5e-4),
        lambda p: torch.optim.SGD(p, 0.01, momentum=0.9, weight_decay=5e-4)),
    "Adam, η=1e-3":                  (lambda p: MyAdam(p, 1e-3),
                                      lambda p: torch.optim.Adam(p, 1e-3)),
    "Adam, + weight decay":          (lambda p: MyAdam(p, 1e-3, weight_decay=5e-4),
                                      lambda p: torch.optim.Adam(p, 1e-3, weight_decay=5e-4)),
}
t2a = pd.DataFrame([{"optimizer": k, "steps": 30, **compare_with_torch(*v)}
                    for k, v in checks.items()])
display(t2a.style.format({"max |θ_mine − θ_torch|": "{:.1e}",
                          "max |θ_N − θ_0| (distance moved)": "{:.1e}"}).hide(axis="index"))
print("SmallCNN parameters:", f"{n_params(SmallCNN()):,} (no BN) |",
      f"{n_params(SmallCNN(bn=True)):,} (BN)")
```

optimizer	steps	allclose (every parameter)	max |θ_mine − θ_torch|	max |θ_N − θ_0| (distance moved)
SGD, η=0.05	30	True	0.0e+00	1.7e-02
SGD+momentum, η=0.01, μ=0.9	30	True	0.0e+00	3.0e-02
SGD+momentum, + weight decay	30	True	2.8e-17	3.0e-02
Adam, η=1e-3	30	True	7.8e-15	2.6e-02
Adam, + weight decay	30	True	2.7e-16	2.8e-02

```
SmallCNN parameters: 620,362 (no BN) | 620,586 (BN)
```

Interpretation. All five configurations match `torch.optim` after 30 steps (`allclose` True for every parameter). SGD with and without momentum agrees bit for bit (max $|\Delta\theta| = 0$; 2.8×10^{-17} with weight decay). Adam differs by at most 7.8×10^{-15}, which is float64 rounding: PyTorch evaluates the same update in a different order, dividing by $\sqrt{1-\beta_2^t}$ inside the denominator and folding $1/(1-\beta_1^t)$ into the step size. The check is not trivial, because the parameters moved by $1.7\text{-}3.0 \times 10^{-2}$, about 10^{12} times the discrepancy. This confirms PyTorch's momentum convention and Adam's bias-corrected moments.

(b) Trajectories on $f(x, y) = \frac{1}{2}(x^2 + 50y^2)$

How this works

- $\nabla f = (x,\ 50y)$ and the Hessian is $\mathrm{diag}(1, 50)$, so $\kappa = 50$: one learning rate must suit a flat direction (x) and a steep one (y).
- GD multiplies x by $1 - \eta$ and y by $1 - 50\eta$, and is stable only for $\eta < 2/50$. So $\eta = 0.035$ gives a y zig-zag (factor −0.75) and an x crawl (0.965 per step).
- Momentum ($\mu = 0.9$, same η): both modes get complex roots of modulus $\sqrt{\mu}$, so every direction decays like $\mu^{t/2}$. Adam ($\eta = 0.3$) scales each coordinate by its RMS gradient, so its first steps move $\approx \eta$ in each coordinate (a 45° path).
- All three start at $(-8, 1)$ and run 100 steps with my optimizers from (a). The y-axis is stretched.

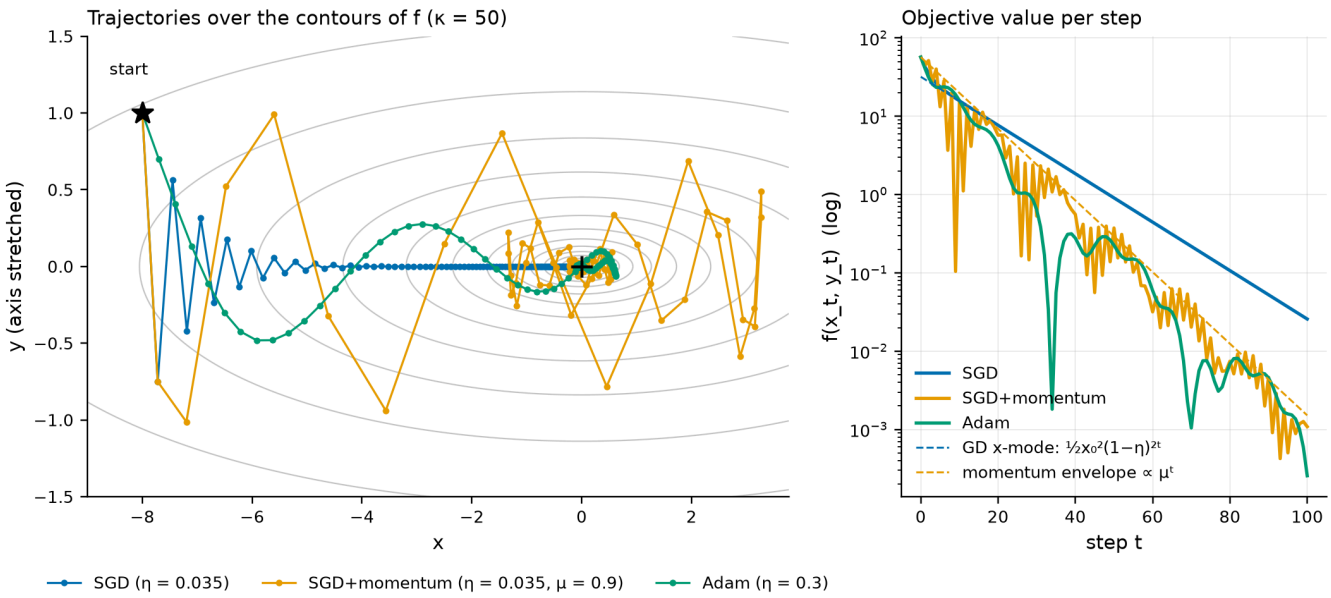
```python
def run_quadratic(make_opt, start=(-8.0, 1.0), steps=100):
    p = torch.tensor(start, dtype=torch.float64, requires_grad=True)
    opt = make_opt([p])
    path = [p.detach().clone()]
    for _ in range(steps):
        opt.zero_grad()
        (0.5 * (p[0] ** 2 + 50 * p[1] ** 2)).backward()
        opt.step()
        path.append(p.detach().clone())
    return torch.stack(path).numpy()
```

```
quad = lambda P: 0.5 * (P[..., 0] ** 2 + 50 * P[..., 1] ** 2)
ETA_Q, MU_Q = {"SGD": 0.035, "SGD+momentum": 0.035, "Adam": 0.3}, 0.9
paths = {"SGD": run_quadratic(lambda p: MySGD(p, ETA_Q["SGD"])),
         "SGD+momentum": run_quadratic(lambda p: MySGD(p, ETA_Q["SGD+momentum"], momentum=MU_Q)),
         "Adam": run_quadratic(lambda p: MyAdam(p, ETA_Q["Adam"]))}
for k, P in paths.items():
    f = quad(P)
    first = int(np.argmax(f < 1e-3)) if (f < 1e-3).any() else None
    print(f"{k:13s} after 100 steps (x, y) = ({P[-1, 0]:+.2e}, {P[-1, 1]:+.2e}) | "
          f"f = {f[-1]:.2e} | "
          f"first step with f < 1e-3: {first}")
```

```
SGD           after 100 steps (x, y) = (-2.27e-01, +3.21e-13) | f = 2.57e-02 | first step with f < 1
e-3: None
SGD+momentum  after 100 steps (x, y) = (-3.60e-02, +4.18e-03) | f = 1.09e-03 | first step with f < 1
e-3: 91
Adam          after 100 steps (x, y) = (-1.94e-02, -1.64e-03) | f = 2.56e-04 | first step with f < 1
e-3: 99
```

```
fig, (ax_c, ax_f) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(11.5, 4.3),
                                 gridspec_kw={"width_ratios": [1.65, 1], "wspace": 0.2})
allP = np.concatenate(list(paths.values()))
x_hi = max(3.0, allP[:, 0].max() + 0.5)                      # keep every point in view
y_hi = max(1.5, np.abs(allP[:, 1]).max() + 0.25)
XX, YY = np.meshgrid(np.linspace(-9, x_hi, 400), np.linspace(-y_hi, y_hi, 300))
ax_c.contour(XX, YY, 0.5 * (XX ** 2 + 50 * YY ** 2), levels=np.geomspace(0.02, 60, 14),
             colors="0.78", linewidths=0.7)
for k, P in paths.items():
    extra = f", μ = {MU_Q}" if k == "SGD+momentum" else ""
    ax_c.plot(P[:, 0], P[:, 1], "-o", color=COLORS[k], ms=2.4, lw=1.1,
              label=f"{k} (η = {ETA_Q[k]}{extra})")
ax_c.plot(-8, 1, marker="*", color="black", ms=12, zorder=5)
ax_c.annotate("start", (-8, 1), xytext=(-8.6, 1.25), fontsize=8.5)
ax_c.plot(0, 0, marker="+", color="black", ms=11, mew=1.5, zorder=5)
ax_c.set(xlabel="x", ylabel="y (axis stretched)", xlim=(-9, x_hi), ylim=(-y_hi, y_hi),
         title="Trajectories over the contours of f (κ = 50)")
ax_c.grid(False)
ax_c.legend(loc="upper center", bbox_to_anchor=(0.5, -0.14), ncol=3)

t = np.arange(len(paths["SGD"]))
for k, P in paths.items():
    ax_f.semilogy(t, quad(P), color=COLORS[k], lw=1.7, label=k)
ax_f.semilogy(t, 0.5 * 8 ** 2 * (1 - ETA_Q["SGD"]) ** (2 * t), "--", color=COLORS["SGD"], lw=1,
              label="GD x-mode: ½x₀²(1−η)²ᵗ")
ax_f.semilogy(t, quad(paths["SGD"][0]) * MU_Q ** t, "--", color=COLORS["SGD+momentum"], lw=1,
              label="momentum envelope ∝ μᵗ")
ax_f.set(xlabel="step t", ylabel="f(x_t, y_t)  (log)", title="Objective value per step")
ax_f.legend(loc="lower left")
plt.show()
```



Interpretation. SGD shows both effects of $\kappa = 50$. In y the factor $1 - 50\eta = -0.75$ causes the zig-zag. In x the factor 0.965 leaves it at $x = -0.227$ after 100 steps, exactly on the dashed $\frac{1}{2}x_0^2(1-\eta)^{2t}$ line ($f = 2.6 \times 10^{-2}$). Momentum with the same η builds velocity along the consistent x-gradient and follows the μ^t envelope, first reaching $f < 10^{-3}$ at step 91. Its price is overshoot: both modes decay only at $\sqrt{\mu} \approx 0.95$ per step, so it swings past the minimum to $x > 3$. Adam's first step is exactly $(+0.3, -0.3) = -\eta\,\mathrm{sign}(\nabla f)$: per-coordinate scaling removes the 50× curvature difference, so it heads diagonally and ends with the lowest f (2.6×10^{-4}).

(c) Learning-rate sensitivity of the small CNN

How this works

- The small CNN has **no batch norm** here, so the learning rate's effect isn't damped. Batch norm is added in Task 3(a).
- 15 epochs, batch 128, constant learning rate, no augmentation and no weight decay, using my optimizers from (a). Only the optimizer and η change between runs, and the seed gives every run the same initial weights and batch order.
- Three log-spaced (×10) rates per optimizer. The SGD+momentum grid is 10× lower than plain SGD because its effective step is $\eta/(1-\mu) = 10\eta$. A run whose loss turns inf/NaN is stopped and marked *diverged*.
- The left plot shows the final-epoch validation accuracy (filled markers) and the best epoch (hollow markers). The right plot shows the training loss at each optimizer's best rate, with the other rates faint.

```
LR_GRID = {"SGD": [0.01, 0.1, 1.0], "SGD+momentum": [0.001, 0.01, 0.1], "Adam": [1e-4, 1e-3, 1e-2]}
MAKE_OPT = {"SGD": lambda lr: (lambda ps: MySGD(ps, lr)),
            "SGD+momentum": lambda lr: (lambda ps: MySGD(ps, lr, momentum=0.9)),
            "Adam": lambda lr: (lambda ps: MyAdam(ps, lr))}
EPOCHS_2C = 15
```

```
h2c = {}
for opt_name, lrs in LR_GRID.items():
    for lr in lrs:
        name = f"task2c_{opt_name.replace('+', '_')}_lr{lr:g}"
        h2c[(opt_name, lr)] = run_experiment(name, SmallCNN, MAKE_OPT[opt_name](lr), EPOCHS_2C,
                                             log_every=5)
```

```
task2c_SGD_lr0.01 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 2.2583 | val loss 2.1599 | val acc 24.86% | 2.9 s/epoc
h
task2c_SGD_lr0.01 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 1.5085 | val loss 1.5135 | val acc 45.38% | 2.5 s/epoc
h
task2c_SGD_lr0.01 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 1.2287 | val loss 1.3376 | val acc 52.18% | 2.5 s/epoc
h
task2c_SGD_lr0.01 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 1.0337 | val loss 1.1195 | val acc 61.08% | 2.5 s/epoc
h
task2c_SGD_lr0.1 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 1.8269 | val loss 1.5635 | val acc 44.66% | 2.5 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_lr0.1 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 0.8220 | val loss 0.8868 | val acc 69.02% | 2.5 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_lr0.1 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 0.3725 | val loss 1.0586 | val acc 67.14% | 2.5 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_lr0.1 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 0.1197 | val loss 1.3162 | val acc 69.92% | 2.5 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_lr1 | epoch   1/15 | train loss nan | val loss nan | val acc 9.64% | 2.4 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_lr1: training loss is not finite -> run stopped (diverged)
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.001 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 2.2662 | val loss 2.1894 | val acc 24.08% |
2.7 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.001 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 1.5008 | val loss 1.5008 | val acc 45.36% |
2.6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.001 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 1.2027 | val loss 1.2406 | val acc 56.50% |
2.6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.001 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 1.0056 | val loss 1.0538 | val acc 63.30% |
2.6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.01 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 1.7657 | val loss 1.3975 | val acc 50.26% |
2.6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.01 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 0.7411 | val loss 0.8471 | val acc 70.42% |
2.7 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.01 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 0.3083 | val loss 0.8511 | val acc 74.64% |
2.7 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.01 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 0.0906 | val loss 1.2434 | val acc 74.90% |
2.6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.1 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 1.6048 | val loss 1.2439 | val acc 56.46% | 2.
6 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.1 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 1.0610 | val loss 1.1342 | val acc 62.56% | 2.
7 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.1 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 1.1574 | val loss 1.3387 | val acc 56.68% | 2.
4 s/epoch
task2c_SGD_momentum_lr0.1 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 1.3822 | val loss 1.6446 | val acc 46.24% | 2.
6 s/epoch
task2c_Adam_lr0.0001 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 1.7926 | val loss 1.5682 | val acc 43.68% | 3.0 s/e
poch
task2c_Adam_lr0.0001 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 1.1873 | val loss 1.2093 | val acc 56.88% | 3.0 s/e
poch
task2c_Adam_lr0.0001 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 0.9706 | val loss 1.0348 | val acc 64.48% | 3.0 s/e
poch
task2c_Adam_lr0.0001 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 0.8386 | val loss 0.9253 | val acc 68.66% | 2.9 s/e
poch
task2c_Adam_lr0.001 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 1.4217 | val loss 1.1616 | val acc 59.12% | 2.9 s/ep
och
task2c_Adam_lr0.001 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 0.5921 | val loss 0.7598 | val acc 74.26% | 2.9 s/ep
och
task2c_Adam_lr0.001 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 0.1923 | val loss 0.9567 | val acc 75.18% | 2.9 s/ep
och
task2c_Adam_lr0.001 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 0.0850 | val loss 1.3104 | val acc 74.80% | 2.9 s/ep
och
task2c_Adam_lr0.01 | epoch   1/15 | train loss 2.0024 | val loss 1.5836 | val acc 42.08% | 2.9 s/epo
ch
task2c_Adam_lr0.01 | epoch   5/15 | train loss 1.4075 | val loss 1.4912 | val acc 46.46% | 2.9 s/epo
ch
task2c_Adam_lr0.01 | epoch  10/15 | train loss 1.3336 | val loss 1.4575 | val acc 48.20% | 3.0 s/epo
ch
```

```
task2c_Adam_lr0.01 | epoch  15/15 | train loss 1.2955 | val loss 1.4997 | val acc 47.38% | 2.9 s/epo
ch
```

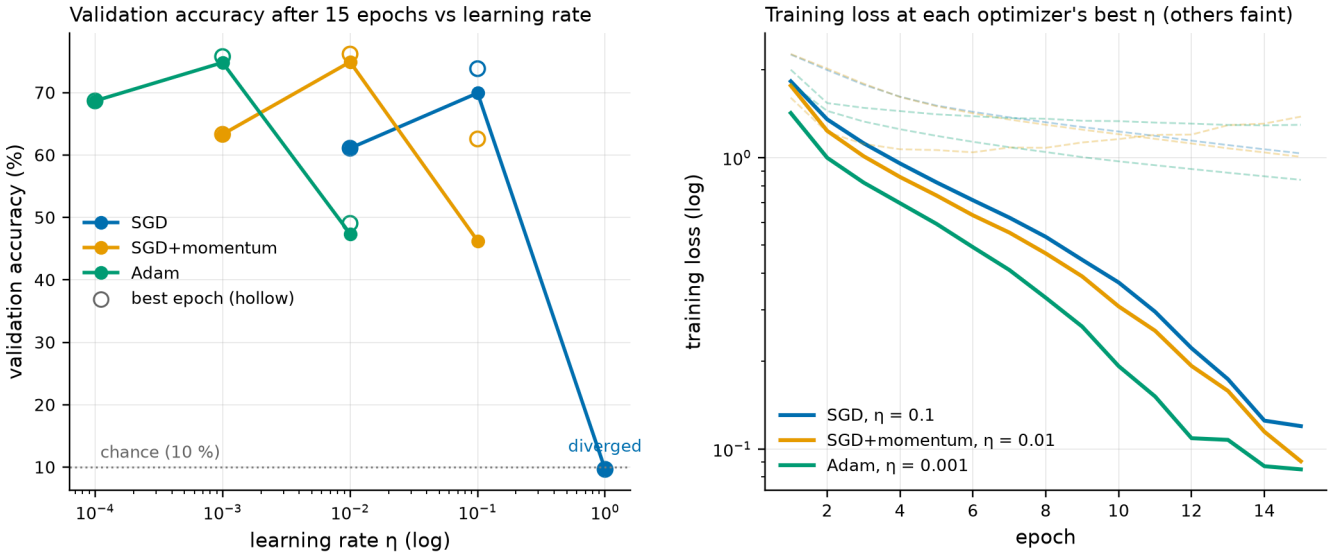
```
rows = []
for (opt_name, lr), h in h2c.items():
    va = 100 * np.array(h["val_acc"])
    rows.append({"optimizer": opt_name, "η": lr, "final val acc (%)": va[-1],
                 "best val acc (%)": np.nanmax(va), "best epoch": int(np.nanargmax(va)) + 1,
                 "final train loss": h["train_loss"][-1], "epochs run": len(va),
                 "status": "diverged" if h["diverged"] else "ok"})
t2c = pd.DataFrame(rows)
display(t2c.style.format({"η": "{:g}", "final val acc (%)": "{:.2f}", "best val acc (%)": "{:.2f}",
                          "final train loss": "{:.4f}"}).hide(axis="index"))
best_lr = {o: d.loc[d["final val acc (%)"].idxmax(), "η"] for o, d in t2c.groupby("optimizer")}
print("best η per optimizer (final val acc):", best_lr)

fig, (ax_a, ax_l) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(11.5, 4.2), gridspec_kw={"wspace": 0.24})
for o in LR_GRID:
    d = t2c[t2c.optimizer == o]
    ax_a.plot(d["η"], d["final val acc (%)"], "-o", color=COLORS[o], lw=1.8, ms=6, label=o)
    ax_a.scatter(d["η"], d["best val acc (%)"], facecolors="none", edgecolors=COLORS[o],
                 s=55, lw=1.2)
    for _, r in d[d.status == "diverged"].iterrows():
        ax_a.annotate("diverged", (r["η"], r["final val acc (%)"]), xytext=(0, 9),
                      textcoords="offset points", ha="center", fontsize=8.5, color=COLORS[o])
ax_a.scatter([], [], facecolors="none", edgecolors="0.4", s=55, label="best epoch (hollow)")
ax_a.axhline(10, color="0.5", ls=":", lw=1)
ax_a.text(1.1e-4, 11.5, "chance (10 %)", fontsize=8.5, color="0.4")
ax_a.set_xscale("log")
ax_a.set(xlabel="learning rate η (log)", ylabel="validation accuracy (%)",
         title="Validation accuracy after 15 epochs vs learning rate")
ax_a.legend(loc="center left")

ep = np.arange(1, EPOCHS_2C + 1)
for o, lrs in LR_GRID.items():
    for lr in lrs:
        tl = h2c[(o, lr)]["train_loss"]
        is_best = lr == best_lr[o]
        ax_l.plot(ep[:len(tl)], tl, color=COLORS[o], lw=2 if is_best else 0.9,
                  alpha=1 if is_best else 0.3, ls="-" if is_best else "--",
                  label=f"{o}, η = {lr:g}" if is_best else None)
ax_l.set_yscale("log")
ax_l.set(xlabel="epoch", ylabel="training loss (log)",
         title="Training loss at each optimizer's best η (others faint)")
ax_l.legend(loc="lower left")
plt.show()
```

optimizer	η	final val acc (%)	best val acc (%)	best epoch	final train loss	epochs run	status
SGD	0.01	61.08	61.08	15	1.0337	15	ok
SGD	0.1	69.92	73.82	12	0.1197	15	ok
SGD	1	9.64	9.64	1	nan	1	diverged
SGD+momentum	0.001	63.30	63.30	15	1.0056	15	ok
SGD+momentum	0.01	74.90	76.16	13	0.0906	15	ok
SGD+momentum	0.1	46.24	62.56	5	1.3822	15	ok
Adam	0.0001	68.66	68.66	15	0.8386	15	ok
Adam	0.001	74.80	75.76	8	0.0850	15	ok
Adam	0.01	47.38	49.04	8	1.2955	15	ok

```
best η per optimizer (final val acc): {'Adam': np.float64(0.001), 'SGD': np.float64(0.1), 'SGD+momen
tum': np.float64(0.01)}
```



Interpretation. Each optimizer has a narrow good range: the best final accuracies are 69.92 % (SGD, $\eta = 0.1$), 74.90 % (SGD+momentum, $\eta = 0.01$) and 74.80 % (Adam, $\eta = 10^{-3}$). One decade away costs 6–29 points, or divergence: SGD at $\eta = 1$ reached a NaN loss in the first epoch (this network has no batch norm). Too small a rate under-trains (61.08 %, 63.30 %, 68.66 %, all still improving at epoch 15); too large a rate stalls (Adam at 10^{-2}) or degrades (momentum at 0.1, training loss 1.06 → 1.38). SGD at 0.1 and momentum at 0.01 follow almost the same loss curve, as expected from the equal effective step $\eta/(1-\mu) = 0.1$. Adam is the least sensitive at the low end because its per-parameter normalisation sets the step size in parameter units.

Task 3 · Regularisation and residual connections (L05, L08)

(a) Regularising a small CNN with batch norm trained on 5k images

How this works

- A seeded 5k subset of the training split overfits quickly, which makes regularisation effects visible. All configurations share SmallCNN with BN, SGD (momentum 0.9, $\eta = 0.05$, cosine to 0), batch 128, 60 epochs and seeds 0, 1, 2 (mean ± std).
- **Weight decay** ($\lambda = 5 \times 10^{-4}$) adds $\lambda\theta$ to the gradient. **Dropout** ($p = 0.5$, hidden FC layer) zeroes units in training and scales survivors by $1/(1-p)$.
- **Flip + crop:** random horizontal flip, random 32×32 crop of the 4-pixel zero-padded image. **Cutout:** one 16×16 square set to 0 (the mean pixel). **Mixup:** $\tilde{x} = \lambda x_i + (1-\lambda)x_j$, loss $\lambda\,\mathrm{CE}(y_i) + (1-\lambda)\,\mathrm{CE}(y_j)$, $\lambda \sim \mathrm{Beta}(1,1)$.
- **Train accuracy** is measured on the *clean* 5k training images (eval mode) after every epoch, so it stays comparable to validation accuracy under augmentation or mixup.

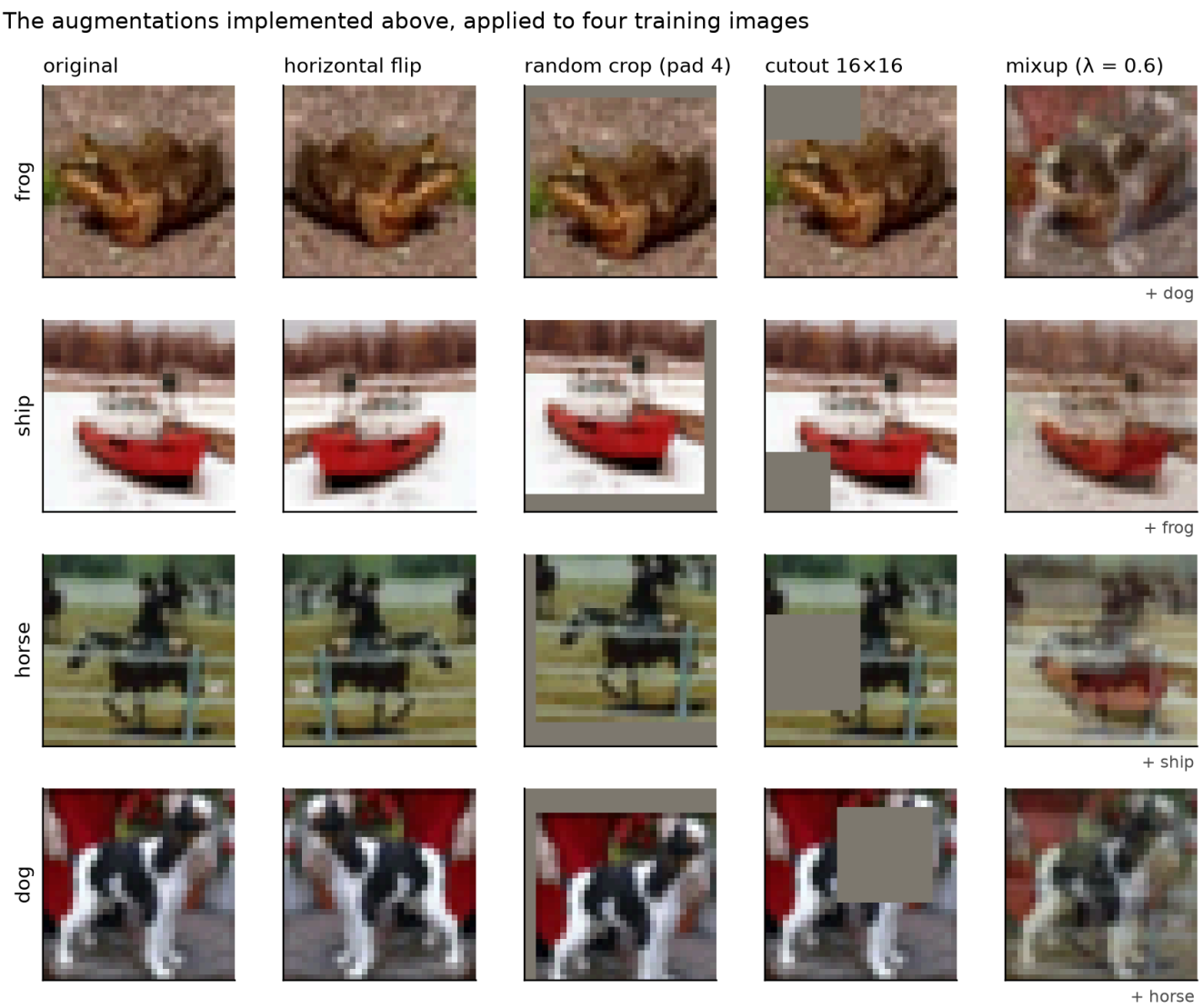
```
def flip_crop(x, pad=4, p_flip=0.5):
    """Random horizontal flip (prob. p_flip) + random 32x32 crop of the zero-padded batch."""
    n, dev = x.size(0), x.device
    x = torch.where(torch.rand(n, 1, 1, 1, device=dev) < p_flip, x.flip(3), x)
    xp = F.pad(x, (pad, pad, pad, pad))                    # 0 = mean pixel after normalisation
    i = torch.randint(0, 2 * pad + 1, (n, 1, 1, 1), device=dev)    # top-left corner of each crop
    j = torch.randint(0, 2 * pad + 1, (n, 1, 1, 1), device=dev)
    ar = torch.arange(32, device=dev)
    rows, cols = i + ar.view(1, 1, 32, 1), j + ar.view(1, 1, 1, 32)
    img = torch.arange(n, device=dev).view(n, 1, 1, 1)
    chan = torch.arange(3, device=dev).view(1, 3, 1, 1)
    return xp[img, chan, rows, cols]                       # advanced indexing -> (n, 3, 32, 32)

def cutout(x, size=16):
    """Zero one size x size square per image (DeVries & Taylor, 2017)."""
    n, _, h, w = x.shape
    cy = torch.randint(0, h, (n, 1, 1), device=x.device)
    cx = torch.randint(0, w, (n, 1, 1), device=x.device)
    ys = torch.arange(h, device=x.device).view(1, h, 1)
    xs = torch.arange(w, device=x.device).view(1, 1, w)
    half = size // 2                                       # rows/cols in [c - 8, c + 8) are cut
    hole = (ys >= cy - half) & (ys < cy + half) & (xs >= cx - half) & (xs < cx + half)
    return x * (~hole).unsqueeze(1)

def mixup(x, y, alpha=1.0):
    """Mix each image with a shuffled partner; returns both label sets and lambda."""
    lam = float(np.random.beta(alpha, alpha))
    perm = torch.randperm(x.size(0), device=x.device)
    return lam * x + (1 - lam) * x[perm], y, y[perm], lam
```

```
# what the network sees: 4 training images, each augmentation applied once (fixed seed)
seed_everything(1)
x4, y4 = X_tr[:4], y_tr[:4]
lam_show = 0.6                                         # fixed λ and partner, for display only
xm, ym2 = lam_show * x4 + (1 - lam_show) * x4.roll(1, dims=0), y4.roll(1, dims=0)
views = {"original": x4, "horizontal flip": x4.flip(3),
         "random crop (pad 4)": flip_crop(x4, p_flip=0.0), "cutout 16×16": cutout(x4),
         f"mixup (λ = {lam_show})": xm}
show = lambda t: (t * STD.view(3, 1, 1).to(t.device) + MEAN.view(3, 1, 1).to(t.device)).clamp(0, 1)
fig, axes = plt.subplots(4, 5, figsize=(8, 6.6))
for c, (title, v) in enumerate(views.items()):
    for r in range(4):
```

```
        ax = axes[r, c]
        ax.imshow(show(v[r]).permute(1, 2, 0).cpu().numpy())
        ax.set_xticks([]); ax.set_yticks([]); ax.grid(False)
        if r == 0:
            ax.set_title(title, fontsize=9)
        if c == 0:
            ax.set_ylabel(CLASSES[y4[r]], fontsize=9)
        if c == 4:
            ax.text(31, 33, f"+ {CLASSES[ym2[r]]}", ha="right", va="top", fontsize=7.5, color="0.3")
fig.suptitle("The augmentations implemented above, applied to four training images",
             x=0.02, ha="left", fontsize=10)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



Interpretation. Each transform does what its definition says. The flip mirrors the scene. The crop shifts the image by up to 4 pixels and fills the border with the grey mean pixel (0 after normalisation). Cutout hides a 16×16 square, which the border clips for frog and ship. Mixup blends two images 0.6 / 0.4, and the loss mixes their labels in the same ratio. Flips, shifts and occlusions keep the class, so they create new label-preserving training images, whereas mixup creates images between classes and asks for correspondingly mixed predictions.

```
sub = torch.randperm(len(X_tr), generator=torch.Generator().manual_seed(SEED))[:5000].to(DEVICE)
X_sub, y_sub = X_tr[sub], y_tr[sub]
print("5k training subset, images per class:", torch.bincount(y_sub, minlength=10).tolist())

EPOCHS_3A, SEEDS_3A = 60, (0, 1, 2)
COSINE = lambda opt, total_steps: torch.optim.lr_scheduler.CosineAnnealingLR(opt, T_max=total_steps)
REG_CONFIGS = {
    "baseline":     {},
    "weight decay": {"wd": 5e-4},
    "dropout":      {"p_drop": 0.5},
    "flip+crop":    {"augment": flip_crop},
    "cutout":       {"augment": cutout},
    "mixup":        {"mix_fn": mixup},
    "all combined": {"wd": 5e-4, "p_drop": 0.5, "augment": lambda x: cutout(flip_crop(x)),
                     "mix_fn": mixup},
}
COLORS.update({"baseline": "#555555", "weight decay": "#0072B2", "dropout": "#56B4E9",
               "flip+crop": "#009E73", "cutout": "#E69F00", "mixup": "#CC79A7",
               "all combined": "#D55E00"})

def run_reg(cfg_name, seed):
    cfg = REG_CONFIGS[cfg_name]
    return run_experiment(f"task3a_{cfg_name.replace(' ', '_').replace('+', '_')}_s{seed}",
                          lambda: SmallCNN(bn=True, p_drop=cfg.get("p_drop", 0.0)),
                          lambda ps: torch.optim.SGD(ps, lr=0.05, momentum=0.9,
                                                     weight_decay=cfg.get("wd", 0.0)),
                          EPOCHS_3A, X=X_sub, y=y_sub, make_sched=COSINE,
                          augment=cfg.get("augment"), mix_fn=cfg.get("mix_fn"),
                          eval_train=(X_sub, y_sub), seed=seed)

h3a = {}
for cfg_name in REG_CONFIGS:
    with contextlib.redirect_stdout(io.StringIO()):         # one summary line per config instead
        runs = [run_reg(cfg_name, s) for s in SEEDS_3A]
    h3a[cfg_name] = runs
    tr = [100 * r["train_acc"][-1] for r in runs]
    va = [100 * r["val_acc"][-1] for r in runs]
    print(f"{cfg_name:13s} | clean train acc {np.mean(tr):6.2f} % | val acc {np.mean(va):5.2f} ± "
          f"{np.std(va):.2f} % | {np.mean([np.mean(r['epoch_time']) for r in runs]):.2f} s/epoch")
```

```
5k training subset, images per class: [493, 510, 507, 485, 472, 514, 506, 509, 529, 475]
baseline      | clean train acc  99.98 % | val acc 64.23 ± 0.17 % | 0.29 s/epoch
weight decay  | clean train acc  99.99 % | val acc 65.20 ± 0.09 % | 0.30 s/epoch
dropout       | clean train acc  99.37 % | val acc 65.63 ± 0.32 % | 0.24 s/epoch
flip+crop     | clean train acc  92.10 % | val acc 71.79 ± 0.34 % | 0.28 s/epoch
cutout        | clean train acc  99.93 % | val acc 66.35 ± 0.17 % | 0.29 s/epoch
mixup         | clean train acc  99.89 % | val acc 63.97 ± 0.44 % | 0.31 s/epoch
all combined  | clean train acc  62.73 % | val acc 58.22 ± 1.13 % | 0.37 s/epoch
```

```
rows = []
for cfg_name, runs in h3a.items():
    tr = np.array([100 * r["train_acc"][-1] for r in runs])
    va = np.array([100 * r["val_acc"][-1] for r in runs])
    rows.append({"configuration": cfg_name, "train acc (%)": f"{tr.mean():.2f} ± {tr.std():.2f}",
                 "val acc (%)": f"{va.mean():.2f} ± {va.std():.2f}", "gap (pts)": (tr - va).mean(),
                 "Δ val vs baseline (pts)": np.nan, "_va": va.mean()})
t3a = pd.DataFrame(rows)
t3a["Δ val vs baseline (pts)"] = t3a["_va"] - t3a.loc[t3a.configuration == "baseline", "_va"].item()
fmt = {"gap (pts)": "{:.2f}", "Δ val vs baseline (pts)": "{:+.2f}"}
display(t3a.drop(columns="_va").style.format(fmt).hide(axis="index"))

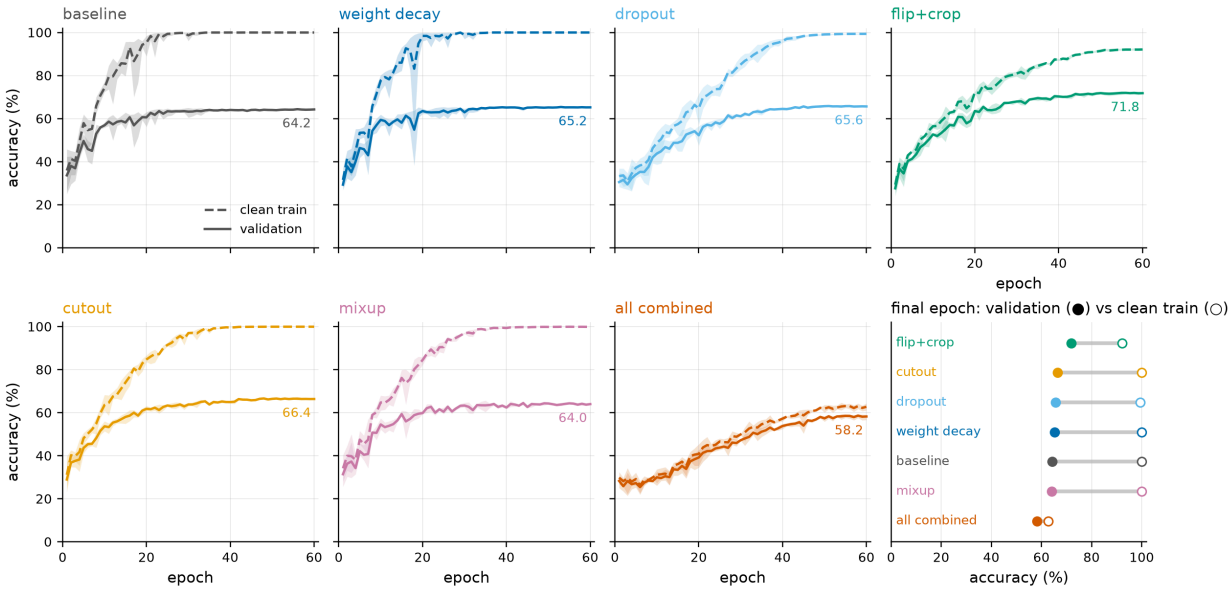
ep = np.arange(1, EPOCHS_3A + 1)
fig, axes = plt.subplots(2, 4, figsize=(13, 6.2), gridspec_kw={"hspace": 0.34, "wspace": 0.08})
for ax, (cfg_name, runs) in zip(axes.flat, h3a.items()):
    col = COLORS[cfg_name]
    for key, ls, lab in (("train_acc", "--", "clean train"), ("val_acc", "-", "validation")):
```

```
        A = 100 * np.array([r[key] for r in runs])
        ax.fill_between(ep, A.min(0), A.max(0), color=col, alpha=0.18, lw=0)
        ax.plot(ep, A.mean(0), ls, color=col, lw=1.6, label=lab)
    va_end = 100 * np.mean([r["val_acc"][-1] for r in runs])
    ax.annotate(f"{va_end:.1f}", (EPOCHS_3A, va_end), xytext=(-2, -12), textcoords="offset points",
                ha="right", fontsize=8.5, color=col)
    ax.set_title(cfg_name, color=col)
    ax.set(xlim=(0, EPOCHS_3A + 1), ylim=(0, 102))
for k, ax in enumerate(axes.flat[:7]):        # shared-axis look; the 8th panel keeps its own axes
    if k % 4:
        ax.set_yticklabels([])
    if k < 3:
        ax.set_xticklabels([])
    else:
        ax.set_xlabel("epoch")
axes[0, 0].legend(loc="lower right")
for ax in axes[:, 0]:
    ax.set_ylabel("accuracy (%)")

# 8th panel: final clean-train vs validation accuracy per config, sorted by validation accuracy
ax = axes[1, 3]
order = t3a.sort_values("_va")["configuration"].tolist()
for k, cfg_name in enumerate(order):
    runs = h3a[cfg_name]
    tr = 100 * np.mean([r["train_acc"][-1] for r in runs])
    va = 100 * np.mean([r["val_acc"][-1] for r in runs])
    ax.plot([va, tr], [k, k], color="0.8", lw=2.5, zorder=1)
    ax.scatter(tr, k, facecolors="white", edgecolors=COLORS[cfg_name], s=34, zorder=3)
    ax.scatter(va, k, color=COLORS[cfg_name], s=34, zorder=3)
    ax.text(2, k, cfg_name, va="center", fontsize=8.5, color=COLORS[cfg_name])
ax.set_title("final epoch: validation (●) vs clean train (○)")
ax.set_xlabel("accuracy (%)")
ax.set(xlim=(0, 102), ylim=(-0.7, len(order) - 0.3), yticks=[])
ax.grid(axis="y", visible=False)
fig.suptitle("Small CNN with BN on 5k images: mean of 3 seeds (band = min–max)", x=0.01, ha="left",
             fontsize=10)
plt.show()
```

configuration	train acc (%)	val acc (%)	gap (pts)	Δ val vs baseline (pts)
baseline	99.98 ± 0.02	64.23 ± 0.17	35.75	+0.00
weight decay	99.99 ± 0.02	65.20 ± 0.09	34.79	+0.97
dropout	99.37 ± 0.20	65.63 ± 0.32	33.74	+1.40
flip+crop	92.10 ± 0.36	71.79 ± 0.34	20.31	+7.57
cutout	99.93 ± 0.01	66.35 ± 0.17	33.58	+2.13
mixup	99.89 ± 0.02	63.97 ± 0.44	35.92	-0.25
all combined	62.73 ± 1.34	58.22 ± 1.13	4.51	-6.01

Small CNN with BN on 5k images: mean of 3 seeds (band = min–max)



Interpretation. Without augmentation every model memorises the 5k images: the baseline reaches 99.98 % clean training accuracy but 64.23 ± 0.17 % on validation, and its validation loss rises from 1.37 (epoch 11) to 2.12. Weight decay (+0.97) and dropout (+1.40) help only slightly; the gap stays above 33 points. Augmentation teaches invariances the labels really have: flip + crop gives 71.79 % (+7.57) and halves the gap, and cutout adds +2.13. Mixup does not raise accuracy (−0.25) but stops over-confidence: its validation loss is 1.12 instead of 2.12. All combined over-regularises this model for 60 epochs (clean training accuracy only 62.73 %, loss still falling), so it underfits to 58.22 %. With seed-to-seed std ≤ 0.44 points (1.13 for all combined), every difference except mixup's exceeds seed noise.

(b) Plain vs residual networks of depth $6n + 2$ (n = 1, 3, 9 → depth 8, 20, 56)

How this works

- **Architecture** (He et al., 2016): conv 3×3 (16) → 3 stages × n basic blocks (16/32/64 channels, stride 2 entering stages 2 and 3) → global average pooling → FC, with BN after every conv and Kaiming init.
- **Only the shortcut differs:** residual block $\mathrm{ReLU}(F(x) + x)$, plain block $\mathrm{ReLU}(F(x))$. Option A everywhere (identity; stride-2 subsampling and zero-padded channels where the shape changes), so both families have identical parameter counts.
- **Same training for all six:** SGD (momentum 0.9, $\eta = 0.1$, cosine), weight decay 10^{-4}, batch 128, 30 epochs, flip + crop.
- **Why shortcuts help:** $x_{l+1} = x_l + F(x_l)$ gives $\partial L/\partial x_l = \partial L/\partial x_L \left(1 + \partial_{x_l} \sum_k F(x_k)\right)$. The "1" carries the gradient straight back, and a block becomes the identity by learning $F \approx 0$.

```
class BasicBlock(nn.Module):
    """conv3x3-BN-ReLU-conv3x3-BN, (+ option-A shortcut), ReLU."""
    def __init__(self, c_in, c_out, stride, residual):
        super().__init__()
        self.residual, self.stride, self.extra = residual, stride, c_out - c_in
        self.conv1 = nn.Conv2d(c_in, c_out, 3, stride, 1, bias=False)
        self.bn1 = nn.BatchNorm2d(c_out)
        self.conv2 = nn.Conv2d(c_out, c_out, 3, 1, 1, bias=False)
        self.bn2 = nn.BatchNorm2d(c_out)

    def shortcut(self, x):                                  # option A: no parameters
        if self.stride > 1:
            x = x[:, :, ::self.stride, ::self.stride]       # subsample 32x32 -> 16x16, 16 -> 8
        if self.extra > 0:                                  # zero-pad the new channels
            x = F.pad(x, (0, 0, 0, 0, self.extra // 2, self.extra - self.extra // 2))
        return x

    def forward(self, x):
        out = F.relu(self.bn1(self.conv1(x)))
        out = self.bn2(self.conv2(out))
        if self.residual:
            out = out + self.shortcut(x)                    # the only plain/residual difference
        return F.relu(out)


class CifarNet(nn.Module):
    """Depth 6n+2: stem conv + 3 stages x n blocks (16/32/64 channels) + GAP + FC."""
    def __init__(self, n, residual):
        super().__init__()
        self.stem = nn.Sequential(nn.Conv2d(3, 16, 3, 1, 1, bias=False), nn.BatchNorm2d(16),
                                  nn.ReLU(inplace=True))
        blocks, c_in = [], 16
        for stage, c_out in enumerate((16, 32, 64)):
            for b in range(n):
                blocks.append(BasicBlock(c_in, c_out, 2 if (stage > 0 and b == 0) else 1, residual))
                c_in = c_out
        self.blocks = nn.Sequential(*blocks)
        self.fc = nn.Linear(64, 10)
        for m in self.modules():
            if isinstance(m, nn.Conv2d):
                nn.init.kaiming_normal_(m.weight, mode="fan_out", nonlinearity="relu")

    def forward(self, x):
        return self.fc(F.adaptive_avg_pool2d(self.blocks(self.stem(x)), 1).flatten(1))


DEPTHS, EPOCHS_3B = {8: 1, 20: 3, 56: 9}, 30
for d, n in DEPTHS.items():
    print(f"depth {d:2d}: plain {n_params(CifarNet(n, False)):>8,} params | "
          f"residual {n_params(CifarNet(n, True)):>8,} params")
```

```
depth  8: plain   75,290 params | residual   75,290 params
depth 20: plain  269,722 params | residual  269,722 params
depth 56: plain  853,018 params | residual  853,018 params
```

```
h3b = {}
for family, residual in (("plain", False), ("residual", True)):
    for d, n in DEPTHS.items():
        h3b[(family, d)] = run_experiment(
            f"task3b_{family}-{d}", lambda n=n, residual=residual: CifarNet(n, residual),
            lambda ps: torch.optim.SGD(ps, lr=0.1, momentum=0.9, weight_decay=1e-4), EPOCHS_3B,
            make_sched=COSINE, augment=flip_crop, eval_train=(X_tr[:5000], y_tr[:5000]),
            log_every=10)
```

```
task3b_plain-8 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 1.5808 | val loss 1.6137 | val acc 44.32% | 4.8 s/epoch
task3b_plain-8 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 0.6419 | val loss 0.6941 | val acc 76.12% | 4.7 s/epoch
```

```
task3b_plain-8 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 0.4643 | val loss 0.4950 | val acc 83.20% | 4.7 s/epoch
task3b_plain-8 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 0.3858 | val loss 0.4574 | val acc 84.28% | 4.2 s/epoch
task3b_plain-20 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 1.7735 | val loss 1.5787 | val acc 42.38% | 8.4 s/epoch
task3b_plain-20 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 0.5679 | val loss 0.6367 | val acc 78.40% | 8.4 s/epoch
task3b_plain-20 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 0.3393 | val loss 0.4549 | val acc 84.84% | 8.7 s/epoch
task3b_plain-20 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 0.2213 | val loss 0.3980 | val acc 87.40% | 8.2 s/epoch
task3b_plain-56 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 2.2741 | val loss 2.1998 | val acc 17.10% | 14.5 s/epoch
task3b_plain-56 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 1.5723 | val loss 1.6252 | val acc 40.60% | 15.9 s/epoch
task3b_plain-56 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 1.2406 | val loss 1.2236 | val acc 57.24% | 14.5 s/epoch
task3b_plain-56 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 1.0328 | val loss 1.0462 | val acc 63.44% | 14.7 s/epoch
task3b_residual-8 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 1.6175 | val loss 1.6079 | val acc 43.52% | 4.7 s/epoc
h
task3b_residual-8 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 0.6607 | val loss 0.7125 | val acc 76.48% | 4.8 s/epoc
h
task3b_residual-8 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 0.4817 | val loss 0.5335 | val acc 82.02% | 1.9 s/epoc
h
task3b_residual-8 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 0.4036 | val loss 0.4795 | val acc 83.82% | 4.7 s/epoc
h
task3b_residual-20 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 1.6026 | val loss 1.5667 | val acc 44.98% | 9.2 s/epo
ch
task3b_residual-20 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 0.4738 | val loss 0.6085 | val acc 78.80% | 9.8 s/epo
ch
task3b_residual-20 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 0.2722 | val loss 0.4384 | val acc 85.82% | 10.0 s/ep
och
task3b_residual-20 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 0.1703 | val loss 0.3729 | val acc 89.14% | 10.0 s/ep
och
task3b_residual-56 | epoch   1/30 | train loss 2.4634 | val loss 2.2656 | val acc 12.46% | 18.0 s/ep
och
task3b_residual-56 | epoch  10/30 | train loss 0.6329 | val loss 0.6999 | val acc 76.40% | 18.4 s/ep
och
task3b_residual-56 | epoch  20/30 | train loss 0.3053 | val loss 0.4369 | val acc 85.82% | 14.8 s/ep
och
task3b_residual-56 | epoch  30/30 | train loss 0.1593 | val loss 0.3907 | val acc 88.74% | 18.5 s/ep
och
```

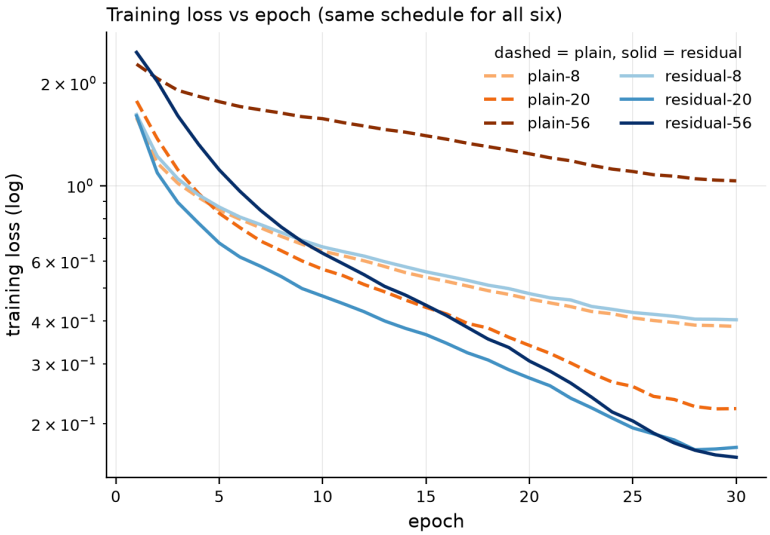
```
rows = []
for (family, d), h in h3b.items():
    rows.append({"network": f"{family}-{d}", "params": f"{h['params']:,}",
                 "final train loss": h["train_loss"][-1],
                 "clean train acc (%)": 100 * h["train_acc"][-1],
                 "val acc (%)": 100 * h["val_acc"][-1], "s / epoch": np.mean(h["epoch_time"])})
t3b = pd.DataFrame(rows)
display(t3b.style.format({"final train loss": "{:.4f}", "clean train acc (%)": "{:.2f}",
                          "val acc (%)": "{:.2f}", "s / epoch": "{:.1f}"}).hide(axis="index"))

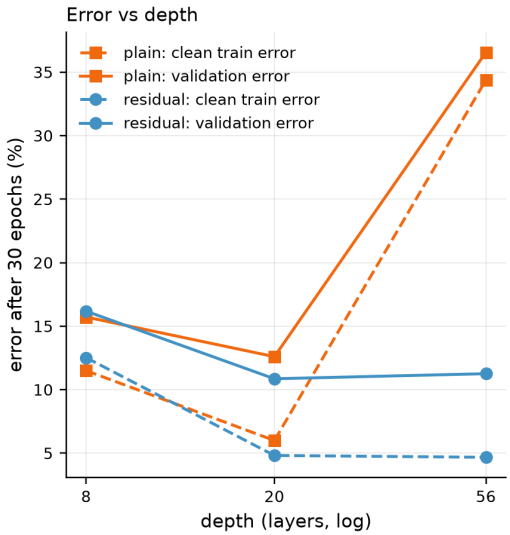
SHADES = {"plain": {8: "#FDAE6B", 20: "#F16913", 56: "#8C2D04"},
          "residual": {8: "#9ECAE1", 20: "#4292C6", 56: "#08306B"}}
ep = np.arange(1, EPOCHS_3B + 1)
fig, (ax_l, ax_d) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(12, 4.4), gridspec_kw={"width_ratios": [1.5, 1],
                                                                       "wspace": 0.22})
for (family, d), h in h3b.items():
    ax_l.plot(ep, h["train_loss"], "--" if family == "plain" else "-", color=SHADES[family][d],
              lw=1.8, label=f"{family}-{d}")
ax_l.set_yscale("log")
ax_l.set(xlabel="epoch", ylabel="training loss (log)",
         title="Training loss vs epoch (same schedule for all six)")
ax_l.legend(ncol=2, loc="upper right", title="dashed = plain, solid = residual", title_fontsize=8.5)

for family, mk in (("plain", "s"), ("residual", "o")):
    ds = list(DEPTHS)
    tr_err = [100 * (1 - h3b[(family, d)]["train_acc"][-1]) for d in ds]
    va_err = [100 * (1 - h3b[(family, d)]["val_acc"][-1]) for d in ds]
    col = SHADES[family][20]
    ax_d.plot(ds, tr_err, "--" + mk, color=col, lw=1.6, ms=6, label=f"{family}: clean train error")
    ax_d.plot(ds, va_err, "-" + mk, color=col, lw=1.6, ms=6, label=f"{family}: validation error")
ax_d.set_xscale("log")
```

```
ax_d.set_xticks(list(DEPTHS), [str(d) for d in DEPTHS])
ax_d.minorticks_off()
ax_d.set(xlabel="depth (layers, log)", ylabel="error after 30 epochs (%)", title="Error vs depth")
ax_d.legend(loc="upper left")
plt.show()
```

network	params	final train loss	clean train acc (%)	val acc (%)	s / epoch
plain-8	75,290	0.3858	88.50	84.28	4.5
plain-20	269,722	0.2213	94.00	87.40	8.6
plain-56	853,018	1.0328	65.62	63.44	14.3
residual-8	75,290	0.4036	87.48	83.82	3.4
residual-20	269,722	0.1703	95.18	89.14	9.9
residual-56	853,018	0.1593	95.32	88.74	17.4





Interpretation. The plain networks show the degradation problem: from 20 to 56 layers the final training loss rises from 0.22 to 1.03 and clean training accuracy falls from 94.00 % to 65.62 % (validation 87.40 % → 63.44 %). Because the *training* error rises, this is an optimisation failure, not overfitting: plain-56 could copy plain-20 and make its extra blocks identities, but SGD does not find that solution. With shortcuts the same depth trains normally; residual-56 has the lowest training loss of all six (0.159) and 88.74 % validation accuracy, 25.3 points above plain-56. The shortcut's "1" gives every block a direct gradient path and makes the identity the default ($F \approx 0$), so extra blocks need not make optimisation harder; at depth 8 it barely matters (84.28 % vs 83.82 %). After only 30 epochs (the paper trains about 180), residual-56 has not yet overtaken residual-20 (89.14 %).

Task 4 · Best CNN with ≤ 500k parameters and ≤ 20 epochs (L08)

How this works

- **Model:** ResNet-9 layout at width 16: conv (16) → conv (32) + pool → residual block → conv (64) + pool → conv (128) + pool → residual block → global max-pool → FC (conv = conv-BN-ReLU; residual block = $x + f(x)$, two convs).
- **Base recipe:** 20 epochs, batch 128, SGD with Nesterov momentum 0.9 and weight decay 5×10^{-4}; one-cycle learning rate (linear warm-up to $\eta_{\max} = 0.1$ over 25 % of steps, then cosine decay); label smoothing $\varepsilon = 0.1$; flip + crop + 8×8 cutout, milder than 3(a)'s 16×16 because stacked regularisation underfit there.
- **Ablation on the validation split:** four runs each change one choice (no shortcuts, no cutout, no weight decay, Adam with $\eta_{\max} = 2 \times 10^{-3}$); the best final validation accuracy picks the final model.
- **The test set** is loaded only in this task's last cell, and used once.

```
def conv_bn(c_in, c_out):
    return nn.Sequential(nn.Conv2d(c_in, c_out, 3, padding=1, bias=False), nn.BatchNorm2d(c_out),
                         nn.ReLU(inplace=True))

class Residual(nn.Module):
    """x + f(x), f = two conv-BN-ReLU layers; with shortcut=False it is the plain f(x)."""
    def __init__(self, c, shortcut=True):
        super().__init__()
        self.f, self.shortcut = nn.Sequential(conv_bn(c, c), conv_bn(c, c)), shortcut

    def forward(self, x):
        return x + self.f(x) if self.shortcut else self.f(x)

def resnet9(width=16, shortcut=True):
    c = width
    return nn.Sequential(conv_bn(3, c),                                              # 32 x 32
                         conv_bn(c, 2 * c), nn.MaxPool2d(2), Residual(2 * c, shortcut),   # 16 x 16
                         conv_bn(2 * c, 4 * c), nn.MaxPool2d(2),                     # 8 x 8
                         conv_bn(4 * c, 8 * c), nn.MaxPool2d(2), Residual(8 * c, shortcut),  # 4 x 4
                         nn.AdaptiveMaxPool2d(1), nn.Flatten(), nn.Linear(8 * c, 10))

print(f"ResNet-9 (width 16) parameters: {n_params(resnet9()):,}  (limit 500,000)")

EPOCHS_4 = 20
BASE_4 = {"shortcut": True, "cutout": True, "wd": 5e-4, "opt": "SGD"}
T4_RUNS = {"base": {}, "no shortcuts": {"shortcut": False}, "no cutout": {"cutout": False},
           "no weight decay": {"wd": 0.0}, "Adam instead of SGD": {"opt": "Adam"}}

def one_cycle(max_lr):
    return lambda opt, total: torch.optim.lr_scheduler.OneCycleLR(
        opt, max_lr=max_lr, total_steps=total, pct_start=0.25, cycle_momentum=False)

def run_t4(run_name):
    cfg = {**BASE_4, **T4_RUNS[run_name]}
    if cfg["opt"] == "SGD":
        make_opt = lambda ps: torch.optim.SGD(ps, lr=0.1, momentum=0.9, nesterov=True,
                                              weight_decay=cfg["wd"])
        sched = one_cycle(0.1)
    else:
        make_opt = lambda ps: torch.optim.Adam(ps, lr=2e-3, weight_decay=cfg["wd"])
        sched = one_cycle(2e-3)
    aug = (lambda x: cutout(flip_crop(x), size=8)) if cfg["cutout"] else flip_crop
    return run_experiment(f"task4_{run_name.replace(' ', '_')}",
                          lambda: resnet9(16, cfg["shortcut"]), make_opt, EPOCHS_4,
                          make_sched=sched, augment=aug, label_smoothing=0.1, save_model=True,
                          log_every=10)
```

```
h4 = {name: run_t4(name) for name in T4_RUNS}
```

```
ResNet-9 (width 16) parameters: 412,954  (limit 500,000)
task4_base | epoch   1/20 | train loss 1.6537 | val loss 1.5883 | val acc 46.86% | 7.4 s/epoch
task4_base | epoch  10/20 | train loss 0.9446 | val loss 0.8204 | val acc 73.50% | 5.8 s/epoch
task4_base | epoch  20/20 | train loss 0.7285 | val loss 0.3844 | val acc 89.48% | 3.6 s/epoch
task4_no_shortcuts | epoch   1/20 | train loss 1.6291 | val loss 1.2068 | val acc 57.62% | 3.7 s/epo
ch
task4_no_shortcuts | epoch  10/20 | train loss 0.9496 | val loss 0.7040 | val acc 77.60% | 4.5 s/epo
ch
task4_no_shortcuts | epoch  20/20 | train loss 0.7307 | val loss 0.3838 | val acc 89.46% | 5.6 s/epo
ch
task4_no_cutout | epoch   1/20 | train loss 1.6182 | val loss 1.4294 | val acc 53.50% | 5.7 s/epoch
task4_no_cutout | epoch  10/20 | train loss 0.8841 | val loss 0.6140 | val acc 81.38% | 6.2 s/epoch
task4_no_cutout | epoch  20/20 | train loss 0.6747 | val loss 0.3714 | val acc 89.86% | 3.4 s/epoch
task4_no_weight_decay | epoch   1/20 | train loss 1.6510 | val loss 1.5578 | val acc 47.94% | 3.6 s/
epoch
task4_no_weight_decay | epoch  10/20 | train loss 0.8906 | val loss 0.5871 | val acc 81.60% | 3.6 s/
epoch
task4_no_weight_decay | epoch  20/20 | train loss 0.7500 | val loss 0.4080 | val acc 88.86% | 3.6 s/
epoch
task4_Adam_instead_of_SGD | epoch   1/20 | train loss 1.8059 | val loss 1.4474 | val acc 48.54% | 3.
8 s/epoch
task4_Adam_instead_of_SGD | epoch  10/20 | train loss 0.9576 | val loss 0.5961 | val acc 81.12% | 4.
7 s/epoch
task4_Adam_instead_of_SGD | epoch  20/20 | train loss 0.7484 | val loss 0.4034 | val acc 88.60% | 6.
7 s/epoch
```

```
base_va = 100 * h4["base"]["val_acc"][-1]
t4 = pd.DataFrame([{"run": name, "params": f"{h['params']:,}",
                    "final val acc (%)": 100 * h["val_acc"][-1],
                    "Δ vs base (pts)": 100 * h["val_acc"][-1] - base_va,
                    "best val acc (%)": 100 * max(h["val_acc"]),
                    "final train loss": h["train_loss"][-1], "s / epoch": np.mean(h["epoch_time"])}
                   for name, h in h4.items()])
display(t4.style.format({"final val acc (%)": "{:.2f}", "Δ vs base (pts)": "{:+.2f}",
                         "best val acc (%)": "{:.2f}", "final train loss": "{:.4f}",
                         "s / epoch": "{:.1f}"}).hide(axis="index"))
FINAL_4 = t4.loc[t4["final val acc (%)"].idxmax(), "run"]
print(f"final model (best final validation accuracy): {FINAL_4}")

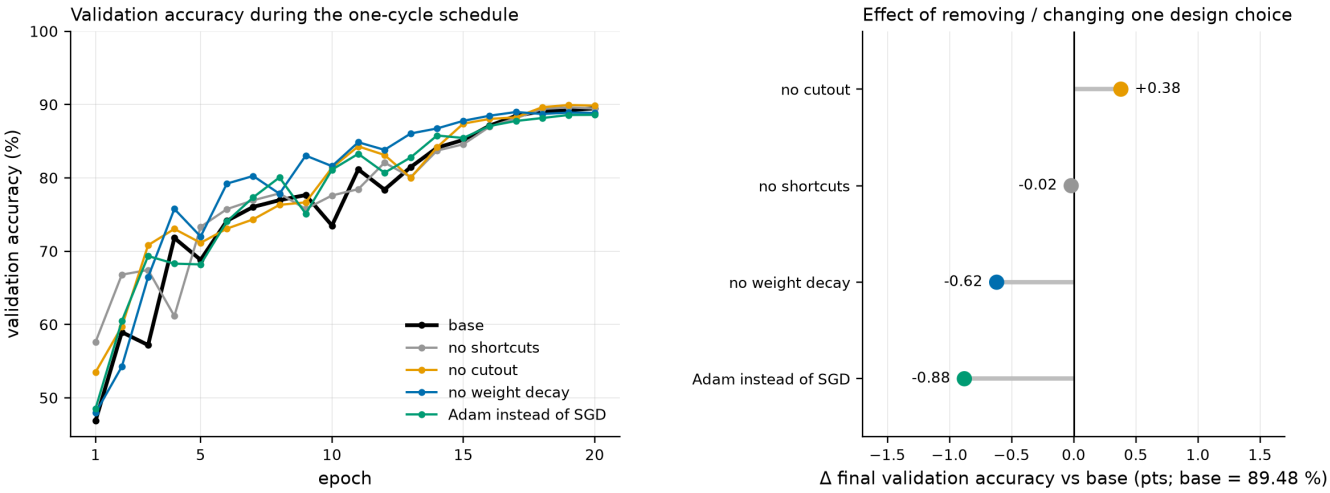
T4_COL = {"base": "black", "no shortcuts": "#999999", "no cutout": "#E69F00",
          "no weight decay": "#0072B2", "Adam instead of SGD": "#009E73"}
fig, (ax_c, ax_d) = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(12.5, 4.2), gridspec_kw={"width_ratios": [1.3, 1],
                                                                         "wspace": 0.5})
ep = np.arange(1, EPOCHS_4 + 1)
for name, h in h4.items():
    ax_c.plot(ep, 100 * np.array(h["val_acc"]), "-o", ms=3, color=T4_COL[name],
              lw=2.2 if name == "base" else 1.3, label=name)
ax_c.set(xlabel="epoch", ylabel="validation accuracy (%)",
         title="Validation accuracy during the one-cycle schedule")
ax_c.set_ylim(max(0, ax_c.get_ylim()[0]), 100)
ax_c.set_xticks([1, 5, 10, 15, 20])
ax_c.legend(loc="lower right")

abl = t4[t4.run != "base"].sort_values("Δ vs base (pts)")
ypos = np.arange(len(abl))
ax_d.hlines(ypos, 0, abl["Δ vs base (pts)"], color="0.75", lw=2.5)
ax_d.scatter(abl["Δ vs base (pts)"], ypos, color=[T4_COL[r] for r in abl.run], s=60, zorder=3)
for y, (_, r) in zip(ypos, abl.iterrows()):
    d = r["Δ vs base (pts)"]
    ax_d.annotate(f"{d:+.2f}", (d, y), xytext=(8 if d >= 0 else -8, 0), textcoords="offset points",
                  ha="left" if d >= 0 else "right", va="center", fontsize=8.5)
ax_d.axvline(0, color="black", lw=1)
ax_d.set_yticks(ypos, abl.run); ax_d.grid(axis="y", visible=False)
```

```
lim = 1.7 * max(1.0, abl["Δ vs base (pts)"].abs().max())
ax_d.set(xlim=(-lim, lim), ylim=(-0.6, len(abl) - 0.4))
ax_d.set(xlabel=f"Δ final validation accuracy vs base (pts; base = {base_va:.2f} %)",
         title="Effect of removing / changing one design choice")
plt.show()
```

run	params	final val acc (%)	Δ vs base (pts)	best val acc (%)	final train loss	s / epoch
base	412,954	89.48	+0.00	89.48	0.7285	5.3
no shortcuts	412,954	89.46	-0.02	89.62	0.7307	5.2
no cutout	412,954	89.86	+0.38	89.94	0.6747	5.5
no weight decay	412,954	88.86	-0.62	88.98	0.7500	3.8
Adam instead of SGD	412,954	88.60	-0.88	88.60	0.7484	5.5

```
final model (best final validation accuracy): no cutout
```



Interpretation. The base recipe reaches 89.48 % validation accuracy with 412,954 parameters in 20 epochs, on par with residual-20 from 3(b) (89.14 % in 30 epochs). Removing the shortcuts changes almost nothing (−0.02), as 3(b) predicts for a network only 8 conv layers deep. Dropping weight decay (−0.62) and switching to Adam (−0.88, at one untuned $\eta_{\max}$) cost the most; in Adam the L2 gradient $\lambda\theta$ is divided by $\sqrt{\hat{v}}$, so weights with large gradients are decayed less, the coupling AdamW removes. Removing cutout gives +0.38 and a lower training loss (0.6747 vs 0.7285), consistent with 3(a)'s finding that extra regularisation slows fitting on a short budget. With a single seed, this and the shortcut difference are within the 0.09–0.44-point seed spread seen in 3(a). Following the protocol, "no cutout" (89.86 %) becomes the final model.

Final evaluation on the test set (used exactly once)

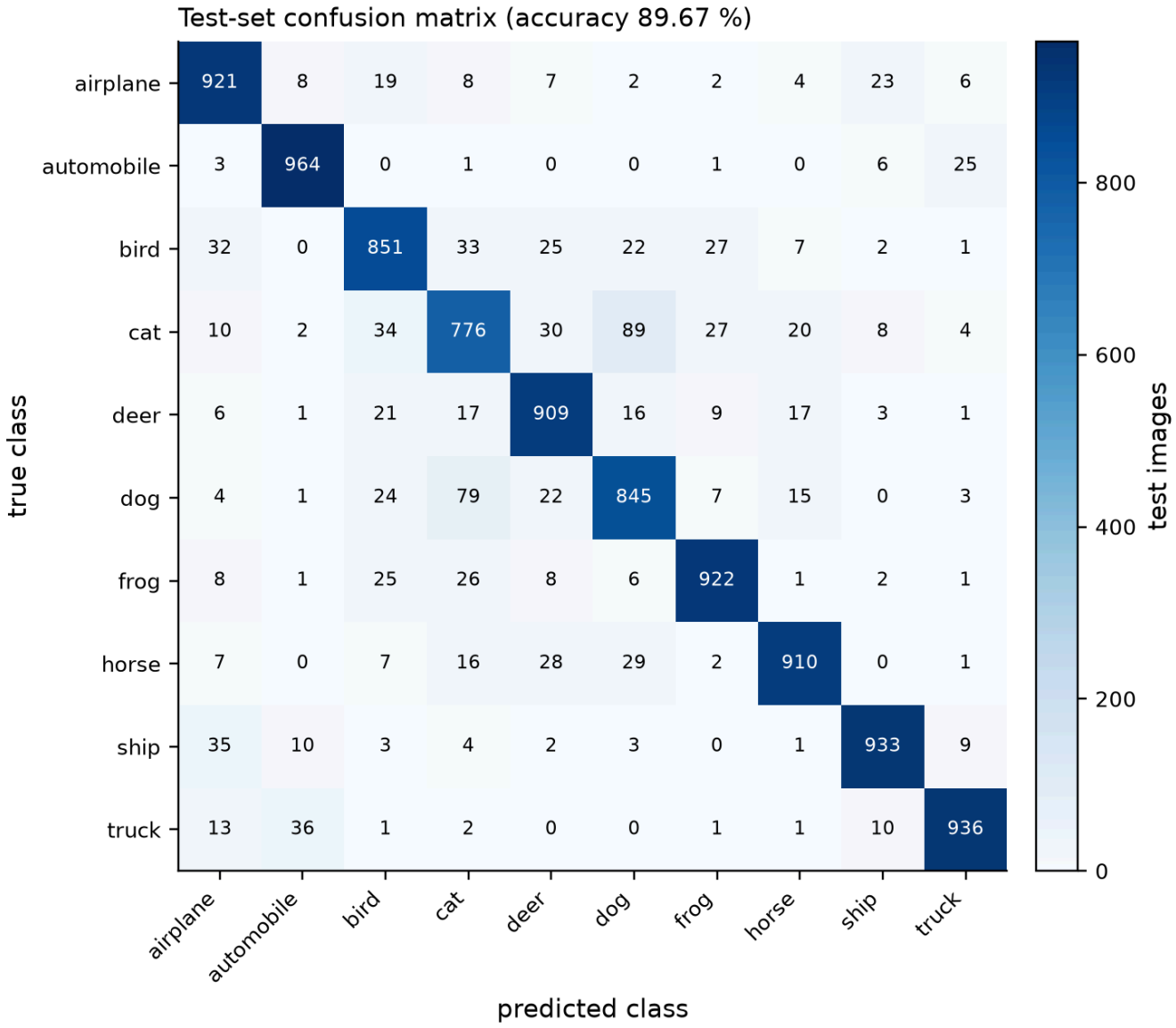
How this works: the CIFAR-10 test set is loaded here for the first time and normalised with the *training-split* statistics. The final model's saved weights get a single evaluation pass. That pass gives both the test accuracy and the confusion matrix, so no choice in this notebook depends on the test result.

```
test_set = torchvision.datasets.CIFAR10(DATA_DIR, train=False, download=True)   # first and only use
X_te = normalize(torch.from_numpy(test_set.data).permute(0, 3, 1, 2)).to(DEVICE)
y_te = torch.tensor(test_set.targets, device=DEVICE)

final_model = resnet9(16, {**BASE_4, **T4_RUNS[FINAL_4]}["shortcut"]).to(DEVICE)
final_model.load_state_dict(torch.load(CKPT_DIR / f"task4_{FINAL_4.replace(' ', '_')}.pt",
                                       map_location=DEVICE, weights_only=True))
final_model.eval()
with torch.no_grad(), torch.autocast(DEVICE.type, dtype=torch.float16, enabled=AMP):
    pred = torch.cat([final_model(xb).argmax(1) for xb, _ in batches(X_te, y_te, 1000)])
test_acc = (pred == y_te).float().mean().item()
print(f"final model: {FINAL_4} | {n_params(final_model):,} parameters | "
      f"validation {100 * h4[FINAL_4]['val_acc'][-1]:.2f} % | TEST ACCURACY {100 * test_acc:.2f} % "
      f"({int((pred == y_te).sum())} / {len(y_te)})")

cm = torch.zeros(10, 10, dtype=torch.long)
cm.index_put_((y_te.cpu(), pred.cpu()), torch.ones(len(y_te), dtype=torch.long), accumulate=True)
cm = cm.numpy()
fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(7, 6))
im = ax.imshow(cm, cmap="Blues")
for i in range(10):
    for j in range(10):
        ax.text(j, i, cm[i, j], ha="center", va="center", fontsize=7.5,
                color="white" if cm[i, j] > cm.max() / 2 else "black")
ax.set_xticks(range(10), CLASSES, rotation=45, ha="right"); ax.set_yticks(range(10), CLASSES)
ax.set(xlabel="predicted class", ylabel="true class",
       title=f"Test-set confusion matrix (accuracy {100 * test_acc:.2f} %)")
ax.grid(False)
fig.colorbar(im, ax=ax, fraction=0.046, pad=0.03, label="test images")
plt.show()
per_class = 100 * cm.diagonal() / cm.sum(1)
print("per-class test accuracy (%):", {c: round(float(a), 1) for c, a in zip(CLASSES, per_class)})
```

```
Files already downloaded and verified
final model: no cutout | 412,954 parameters | validation 89.86 % | TEST ACCURACY 89.67 % (8967 / 100
00)
```




```
per-class test accuracy (%): {'airplane': 92.1, 'automobile': 96.4, 'bird': 85.1, 'cat': 77.6, 'dee
r': 90.9, 'dog': 84.5, 'frog': 92.2, 'horse': 91.0, 'ship': 93.3, 'truck': 93.6}
```

Interpretation. The final model scores 89.67 % on the test set, 0.19 points below its validation accuracy (89.86 %). That is the expected slight optimism from picking the best of five runs on the validation split, so validation was a reliable guide. The 1,033 errors concentrate on visually similar pairs: cat is the weakest class (77.6 %), and cat ↔ dog confusions alone account for 168 errors (16 %). Next come bird ↔ cat (67), truck ↔ automobile (61) and ship ↔ airplane (58), pairs that share shape, texture or sky and water backgrounds at 32×32. Classes with distinctive shapes are easiest: automobile (96.4 %), truck (93.6 %) and ship (93.3 %).

Summary

- **Task 1 (L04, L06).** The hand-written backward passes match autograd to a relative error of at most 1.4×10^{-11} in float64, and `allclose` holds for all six tensors. The MLP peaks at 50.52 % validation accuracy (epoch 7) and then overfits, with 89.38 %

clean train accuracy. In the 10-layer MLP, sigmoid shrinks the layer-1 gradient to 7.9×10^{-5} of the layer-10 gradient, while ReLU with Kaiming init keeps both at the same scale.

- **Task 2 (L05).** My SGD-momentum and Adam match `torch.optim` to within 7.8×10^{-15}. At their best η, momentum (74.90 %) and Adam (74.80 %) beat plain SGD (69.92 %). One decade away from the best η costs 6–29 points, and plain SGD diverges at η = 1.
- **Task 3 (L05, L08).** On the 5k subset, flip + crop is the strongest single regulariser (71.79 % vs 64.23 % for the baseline), while stacking all of them over-regularises (58.22 %). Without shortcuts the 56-layer network ends with a higher training loss than the 20-layer one (1.03 vs 0.22); with shortcuts it trains to 0.16.
- **Task 4 (L08).** A 412,954-parameter ResNet-9 trained for 20 epochs reaches 89.86 % validation and **89.67 % test accuracy**, evaluated once. Most errors are between similar classes, led by cat ↔ dog.